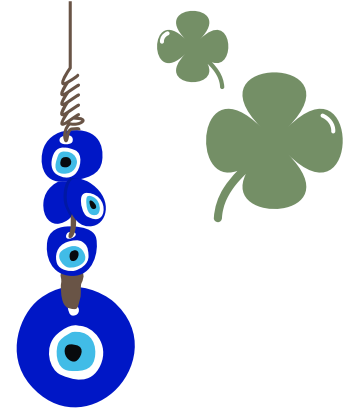
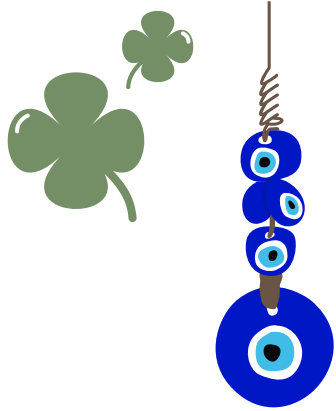




Hope, Fear & Superstitions



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Introduction:

How does superstition help control anxiety? Superstitious practices help give people a false sense of comfort in situations that they feel aren't under their control; it gives them relief from anxiety or so they feel. But there are studies that show that anxiety can be caused or increased owing to superstitious beliefs. There seems to be a link between the desire to be in control over situations, and superstitions. Gen Z also tends to look at manifestations and angel numbers like 11:11. These manifestations have become popular after being promoted by famous social media influencers. Many Gen Z may not know the origin of these but follow it to have a sense of control and a sense of hope, which gives them the reassurance that what they want will happen if they wish at 11:11 . This project takes a lighthearted approach to Gen Z's seeming obsession with superstitious practice through a series of fun memes.



Why I choose this project?:

The reason that I took this class was because I tend to get anxious in certain situations that cause anxiety and I wanted to delve into a deeper understanding of how to manage and cope with my anxiety. Also, get a better understanding of myself why I tend to react the way I do in certain situations and how can improve myself.

For me, music helps me calm down and feel better. I wanted to delve into what makes others anxious and how they cope with it as it made me feel I wasn't alone in this.



What Did We Do In Class?: 5Ws & 1H

- **What?:** what is anxiety?; feeling of fear, dread or uneasy, what does it feel like?; heart racing, sweating and shaking.
- **Who?:** We looked at who gets anxiety; children, adolescents, elderly people, individuals going through trauma, and if it can be transferred genetically; yes it can be, there is a specific gene that is associated with anxiety, what the different hormones affect anxiety and how do they affect it.
- **Where?:** where does anxiety start?; food, biological, childhood trauma etc and where do we go?; bad coping mechanisms like doom scrolling, good coping mechanisms are physical activity, creative outlet and social connections.
- **Why?:** why do we feel anxious; can be external, internal or biological factors.
- **When?:** when does one feel anxious?; stress, substance abuse, traumatic events, fear of change etc, when anxiety starts developing?; personality trait, starts showing in childhood or early adult or later in life, when does it affect your health; short-term problems like increased heart rate, hyperventilation, muscle tension etc whereas long-term problems are sleep disorder, immune weakened etc, when does it become a concern?; excessive worrying, overthinking, physical symptoms etc.
- **How?:** how is anxiety caused?; genetic factors, brain structure and functions, flight/fright response, how do we treat anxiety?; medical treatments, lifestyle changes etc, how certain lifestyle and events lead to anxiety?; stress is a common factor, social situations and external struggle and how social media contributes to anxiety?; compassion culture, fear of missing out etc.
- **Insights:** From this, some of the things that I found interesting was that; anxiety is a feeling of fear, dread and uneasiness. Anxiety can be caused by situations, people, genetics, because of stress, traumatic experiences etc. One thing that I found interesting was that Anxiety is basically the fear of uncertainty. This resonated with me because all of us have felt anxious during the pandemic, which has caused a lot of uncertainty about the future.



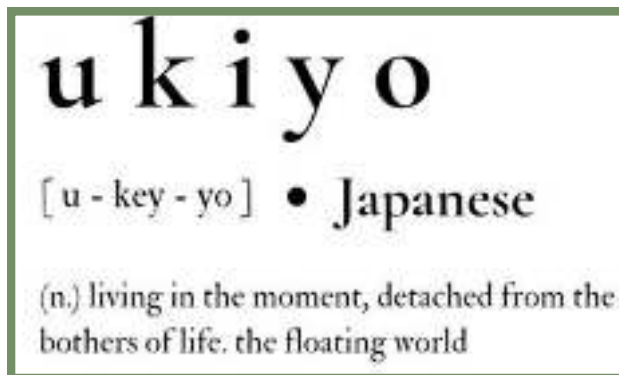
What Did We Do In Class?: Understanding Anxiety [Masterclass]

- **Probability versus Possibility:** What we think is a possibility, the probability is very little of it happening and one should always look at probability.
- **Words related to Anxiety:** Fear, Numbness, Overthinking, Tight chest, self-hate, shiver, crying for no reason, clouded judgement, change in body temperature, headache etc.
- **Anxiety:** it saves us at times, but happening too many times is bad. The factors that cause anxiety are both biological and physical health etc. Psychological factors; perfectionism, past experience and thinking patterns. Environmental Factors; social environment pressure etc. Types of anxiety; generalised anxiety, social anxiety, health anxiety, panic, obsessive-compulsive disorder, fear of the unknown and phobias.
- **Role of Social Media in Anxiety:** It is a double-sided sword, it helps us stay connected to friends but at the same time it causes fear of missing out, comparison, and validation. The worst side is cyberbullying, I feel a good example is X (formally Twitter). Most of the cyberbullying I have seen is on Twitter, also Twitter causes aggression and causes people to react very impulsively to the content. It also caused information overload causing brain rot.
- **Insights:** This masterclass helped me to have a deeper look at how exactly anxiety works. I feel that most of the time we end up looking at the possibility of something bad happening to us than how exactly low the chances are of what we are thinking to happen. It also helped me to understand what are the different types of anxiety and how even something as simple as a phobia can cause a person to get anxious. It gave a fresh perspective to the word “Anxiety.”



What Did We Do In Class?: You are not your thoughts [Masterclass]

- **Anxiety:** This word is derived from Latin word “Anxius” meaning worried, disturbed, narrow, troubled and to constrict. It comes from anticipation of fear of the future, fear of failure, social status, wanting to do better than others and oneself, change; any change causes takes a long time for us to get used.
- **Yutori:** The conscious act slowing down to allow us to savor the world around us. It is the refusal to rush, no talking just absorbing the world around us with no goal but to see. It is also called spaciousness.
- **Negative Capabilities:** inaction, uncertainty, paradox, ambiguity, refinement and containment are some of the negative effects of anxiety
- **Insights:** One thing that stuck with me was how change causes anxiety. Change is something that is always a part of our lives. I think that change is something that everyone finds difficult to get used to. Another fact that interested me was how people react to change, from my experience, I turned to music for comfort. The Japanese word “Yutori” means the conscious act of slowing down to allow us to savour the world around us. Containment made me think about superstitions, and how it makes our decision-making restricted at times like the number 13 being a bad number, it causes people to fear anything with that number.



What Did We Do In Class?: Journaling [Masterclass]

- **Journaling:** It can record, ideate, reflect. It helps to create more ideas from the record and allows a person to be mindful and in their present. It helps new ideas to expand.
- **Linda Baren Journaling:** It is a review to note down and review what happened during the day. It consists of snapshots and takes about 2:30 minutes.
- **Inside Out 2 “Anxiety”:** How the character was made and how they journaled their progress, helping them get new ideas.
- **Insights:** I feel journaling can be fun and tedious. In my experience, I like to take notes of all the class discussions, which later helps in coming up with ideas, etc. Having seen the movie, it was interesting to take a look at the character's anxiety and how the creators came up with the character. I felt like the lighthearted approach to this heavy topic was very interesting and helped people understand the topic better.



happen/ did	image/ saw	expanding anyone thing deets.
quote/ something that stuck with you	question/ drama	



What Did We Do In Class?: The Anxious Generation [Book]

Steve Jobs introduced smartphones in June 2007. This caused a huge ripple in the lives of children and adolescents, a rewiring of sorts from a play-based childhood to a phone-based childhood. Smartphones caused a lot of problems like a decline in mental health and changes in family dynamics as families not sitting together often causing mental health to decline. There are two main modes in our brain: defend and discover mode. In the discover mode: a person tends to explore and seek new opportunities, making them more social and happier, promoting growth and learning. On the other hand, in the defence mode: people tend to be more anxious, defensive and not a fan of change, making them on edge or alert. A very interesting line was: Kids are antifragile. The author said that kids grow well under stress to justify this statement. Nowadays, parents are over-protecting, causing the kids anxiety instead of having high self-control and high confidence. Being overprotected causes everything to trigger them and blocks the growth of the immune system.

In 1911, Edward Thorndike conducted an experiment by putting cats inside a puzzle box, meaning they had to do a task to get out of the box to get food. In this case, pulling at a ring connected to the latch by a chain. He observed that at first, the cats were restless and didn't know what to do, but eventually, they did it. The time taken for them to figure out the puzzle reduced each puzzle they solved. His insights were that it was because of muscle memory as the activity was a training of the brain activity, which meant the cats had a learning curve.

Initially, Facebook, Friendster and Myspace were social networking sites used only to find high school friends and fans of a particular artist. But then, in 2010, the front-facing camera was introduced, causing more apps like Instagram, Twitter, etc, to become social media apps. All these apps affect the children and adolescents who are the most vulnerable. They were overprotected and kept at home due to national mania, causing them to gravitate towards the devices to keep themselves more occupied. Some of the harms caused by smartphones are social deprivation, sleep deprivation, attention fragmentation and addiction. In sleep deprivation, the kids tend to spend a long time on the phone and sleep late.



Since they had to get up early for school the next day, they ended up having less sleep. If they are sleep-deprived, they are more irritable, unable to focus and anxious, which reduces their reaction time, causing an elevation in risk of accidents. In social deprivation, smartphones were taking more of their attention and that caused them to isolate from people. The lockdown caused it to worsen, and people preferred to stay indoors and be on their devices than go outside. In attention fragmentation, their attention span is reduced drastically. They tend to multi-task, which ends in them shifting to and from tasks. The shift takes more time than the tasks itself. In addition, they tend to get addicted to their devices. They tend to be more irritable, anxious and insomniacs.

One of the most important examples is of Alexis Spence. In this example, she was influenced a lot by Instagram very early as in her fifth. Her mental and physical health declined. The shift to phone-based social life in the early 2010s caused widespread mental health issues. Group-level effects, like cultural and social changes, amplify individual-level harms. Key Points on Social Media Usage Differences and Impact Gender Differences in Social Media Use Boys: Prefer text based platforms (e.g., Reddit) and YouTube. Spend more time on online multiplayer video games. Girls: Heavier users of visually oriented platforms (Instagram, Snapchat, Pinterest, Tumblr). Platform Impact on Well-Being. High Usage: Among Girls By 2015, 1 in 7 American girls spent over 40 hours weekly on social media (equivalent to a full-time job). Such high usage was rare before smartphones became widely available in the early 2010s. Girls spend more time on platforms that negatively affect mental health. Larger increases in anxiety and depression are observed in girls compared to boys.

Across the nation, most of the transformation happened between 2010 and 2015, which provided evidence that pointed out that the combination of smartphones and social media is the major contributor to their increased anxiety and depression. Since the 1970s, the real world has changed in a way that made it less hospitable to boys and young men, leading them to push away from the real world as they felt more purposeless, useless and adrift.



Then, starting in the 70s and moving through 2010, the digital world brought more ways for boys to do the building activities they craved, such as exploring, competing, playing at war, mastering skills, and watching hardcore explicit content, all of this through a small screen. That's the pull. Boys were more inclined towards immersive gaming environments. It pulled the boys decisively away from face-to-face or shoulder-to-shoulder interaction. ("mass psychological breakdown") Many boys were lost in cyberspace, which made them more fragile, fearful and risk-averse on Earth. Most of them neglected their academic responsibilities and physical health. Haidt argues that this "hole" remains a central aspect of the human experience, but today, many people attempt to fill it in ways that often lead to spiritual degradation. Religious practices like prayer, fasting, and communal worship gave people a sense of purpose and connection, which is now slowly fading away.



What Did We Do In Class?: The Atlas Of The Heart [Book]

In this book, the author describes how emotions affect us and our bodies. As for Anxiety, the person feels dread, worry about the future, and avoidance, meaning pushing away the problem. There are two types of anxiety, namely state and trait. Here, state means a feeling of worry, whereas trait means prone to getting anxious. When it comes to comparison, the author defines it as a feeling that comes with someone near us, either better or worse. When it is someone above us, we tend to feel inferior to them, whereas if it is someone below us, we tend to feel superior to them. This can cause admiration or adoration. Admiration means when we feel inspired by them, whereas adoration means we need meaningful connections with the person. Humiliation is when we feel disregarded, angry and powerless. It causes a feeling of resentment and a need for revenge. Guilt causes a person to feel remorse and regret, it has space for growth. Nostalgia is neither good nor bad, it needs to be balanced. It depends on the memory can be happy or sad. Shame causes self-doubt. Anguish causes self-doubt, powerlessness, and grief. It takes a lot of time to process and always ends up coming back.

The next emotion the author talks about is perfectionism, it makes a person feel the need to earn approval and causes them to have unattainable standards. It makes one feel like something is wrong with them, and also, they don't know when to stop doing a task. Another emotion that causes self-doubt is Insecurity. This emotion is domain-specific, and it causes one to be more self-critical. Wanting something someone else has causes the emotion of envy. When we miss out on an opportunity, it causes the emotion of regret. Embarrassment is what one feels after an awkward mistake, but it ends in laughter, easing the situation. Having something you want to do and doing it is Hope, whereas unrealistic expectations cause the opposite, which is hopelessness. It causes despair and makes one emotionless, caused by the 3Ps. Self-compassion is being kind to oneself, meaning talking to oneself as one with one's friends. Having no stimulation or having nothing to do causes boredom. It causes a person to be irritable, frustrated and lethargic.



When there are two different ideas which contradict each other, it is called a Paradox. For example, vulnerability is sometimes covered by sarcasm and irony. Here, sarcasm is criticism, and irony is jokes and criticism. Disappointment is something that comes from having an unrealistic standard and causes a reality check. Empathy is basically putting oneself in the other person's shoes and understanding their situation. There are two types of empathy, namely, cognitive and effective. Cognitive, being not on an emotional level like how doctors do. Effective, being feeling the pain on an emotional level. On the other hand, Compassion is treating others as equals and sharing humility; it causes a person to understand and help. The near enemy of Compassion is Pity. In Pity, feeling superior to the other one and feeling sorry for others. Belonging and fitting in are like two different sides of the coin. In belonging, there is no judgement, accepted as we are, and it has a genuine connection, whereas in fitting in, the person tries to act how others do so they are accepted.

Connections cause one to be their authentic self, be happier and healthier and help to foster healthy relationships. In disconnection, the author associates it with physical pain and calls it a loss of emotions, isolation and hiding of thoughts. Awe and Wonder are similar, awe being what we express when we observe something and wonder being the desire to explore and understand something. Curiosity and Interest are also alike: curiosity stems from the heart and is a mix of questioning stuff and interest, whereas interest stems from the brain and is a cognitive openness. Confusion is the emotion that is best suited for learning. Loneliness is often confused with shyness and depression. It causes no social interaction, causes a disconnected feeling, feels neglected by people and limits creative thinking. Sympathy is where one doesn't put oneself in the shoes of the other person. They are disconnected from emotion, which causes them to feel disappointed and judge others. They end up disregarding the problem.

The author also talks about feelings of love, trust, betrayal, hurt and self-trust. BRAVING is a part of the trust; its full form is boundaries, reliability, accountability, vault, integrity, non-judgement and generosity. The author says that trust is like taking a risk. Self-trust is trusting oneself and is the first cause of failure when one doesn't trust themselves. Betrayal is a violation of trust, a form of self-betrayal is being a people pleaser to fit in. Hurt is a mix of several emotions; it is an emotional pain that can be unintentional sometimes, and it can turn into anger, causing people to lash out.



The author also talks about joy, heartbreak, calm, contentment, gratitude, tranquillity, foreboding joy, relief, disgust, contempt and many more emotions. The main things that the author talks about are near enemies and far enemies. The near enemy is a state that is similar to the desired state, whereas the far enemy is the opposite of what we want to achieve. Circle of science is another thing the author talks about where deductive reasoning means applying existing theories to specific ones, and inductive reasoning means forming new theories with observed data. The need for grounded confidence is also talked about, and how to achieve it is by staying curious, practising new skills and learning to ramble with vulnerability. The author also talks about embodiment and disembodiment, where embodiment means being aware of the body's emotions, and disembodiment is the exact opposite.



Cultivating Meaningful Connections

It is a capital mistake to think things are too late to be made right, before the clock has not been, instead of there to set free. - Helen from Tangle

- Alan Watts, Zen and the Art of Living

End Goals in relation to the

Level of understanding, emotional, cognitive, and behavioral

Relationships, self, and others

Meaningful connections

Foundational Skills for CMC

Learning to work along with others in a team

Communication skills

Relationships, self, and others

Meaningful connections

Building Strong Relationships

Relationships are the foundation of a strong community

Relationships are the foundation of a strong community

Relationships are the foundation of a strong community

Language & Meaningful Connections

Language is the foundation of a strong community

Language is the foundation of a strong community

Language is the foundation of a strong community

Building the capacity of working along side

Working along side is the foundation of a strong community

Working along side is the foundation of a strong community

Working along side is the foundation of a strong community

Building the capacity of working along side

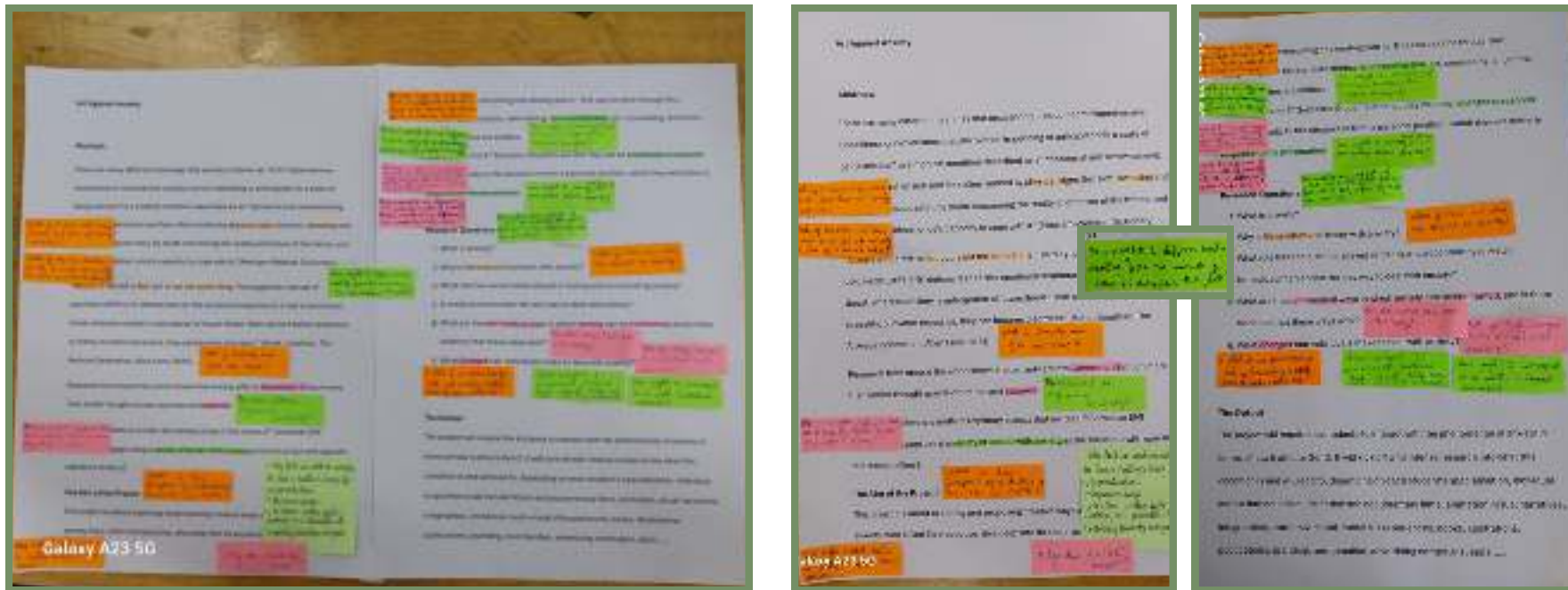
Working along side is the foundation of a strong community

Working along side is the foundation of a strong community

Working along side is the foundation of a strong community

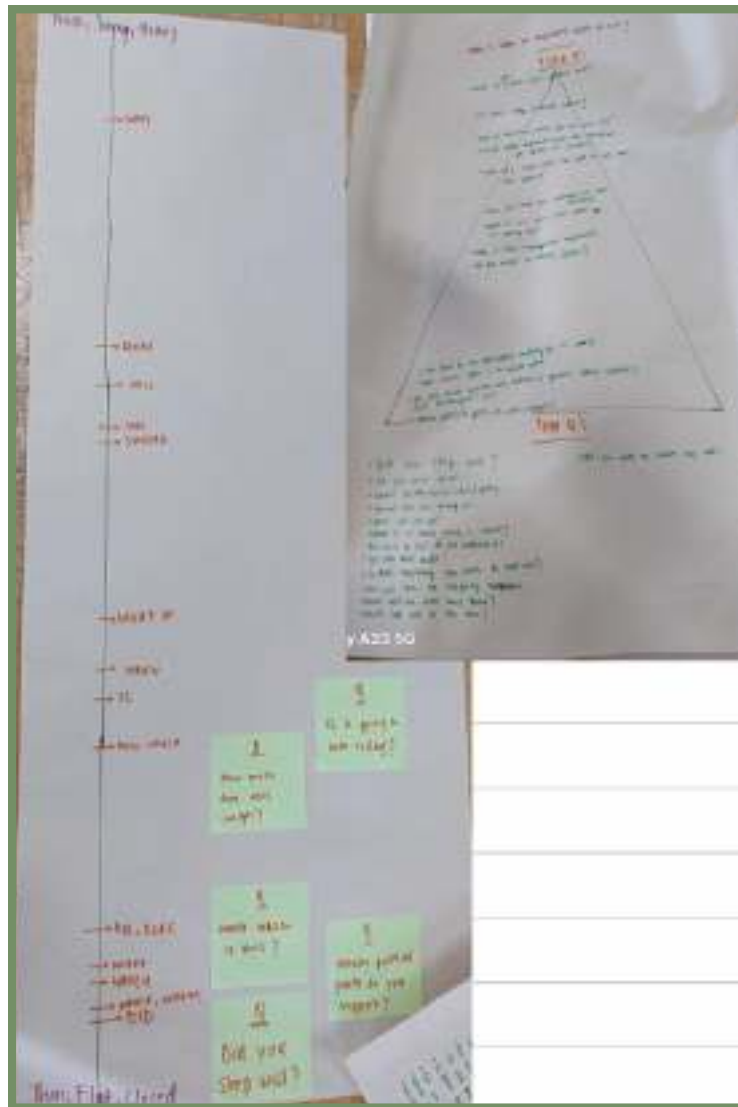


What Did We Do In Class?: Framing An Inquire [Masterclass]



- After looking at the abstract, we had to form questions that came to our mind. The question that came to my mind was “How does culture or superstitions influence anxiety in GenZ?”
- I believe in the whole manifestation theory, so it made me want to see how that all played a role in anxiety and whether it had a positive or negative impact on the people.
- This got me thinking more on this leading me to research more.

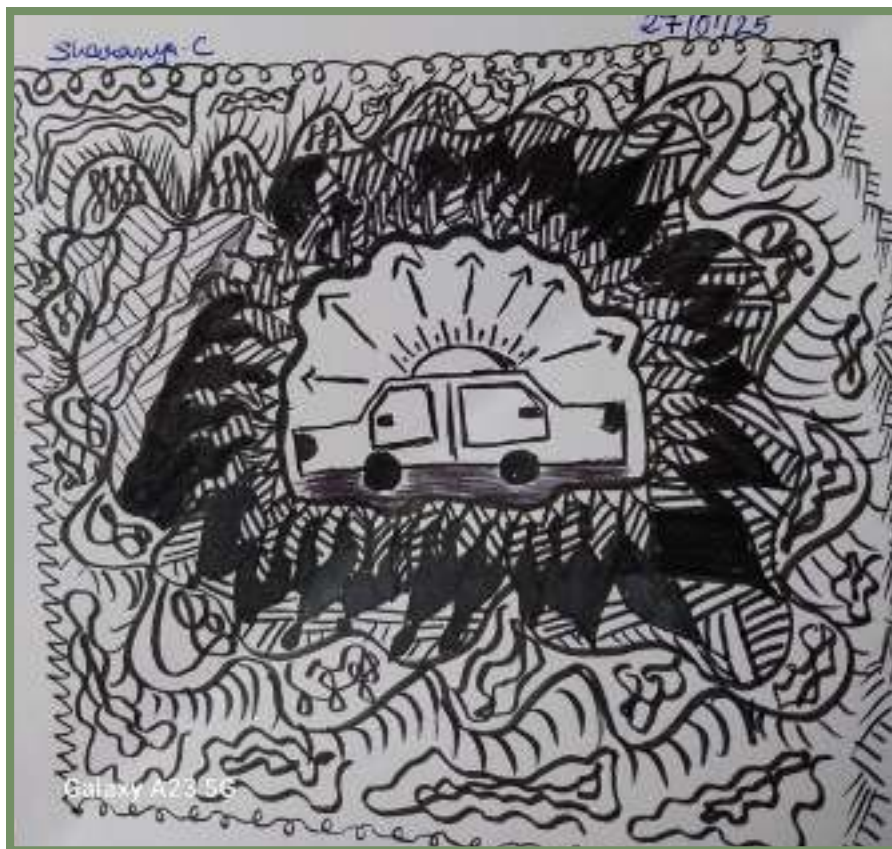




- Another activity we did was to grade the questions like why, what, when etc to make sure which is a thick or thin question.
- Thick questions are questions that help gather a lot of answers. Thin questions, meaning that questions that don't gather a lot of answers or data related for the main question or main topic



What Did We Do In Class?: Zentangles





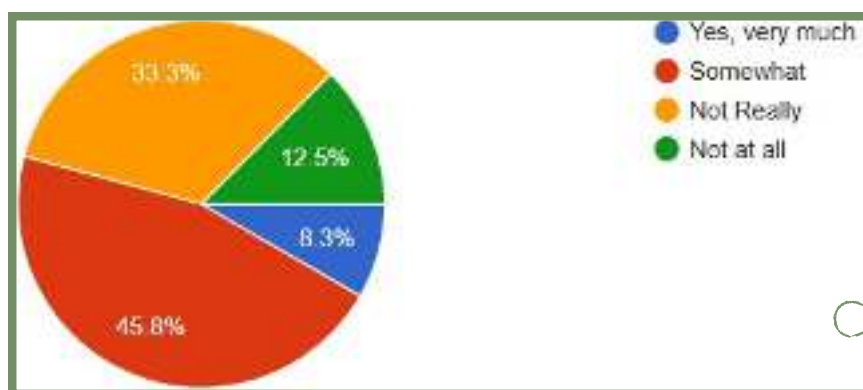
My Idea:

This project is about Superstition and how it correlates to anxiety. GenZ is less superstitious than the other generations, but some superstitions still tend to affect us. GenZ also tends to look at astrology, zodiac signs, angel numbers and manifestation. Some superstitions like knocking on wood for good luck, the evil eye concept etc are still prevalent if not more than the other generations. In this project, I intend to show how superstition affects anxiety among GenZ lightheartedly. Since anxiety is a heavy topic, I felt that a lighthearted approach would help people relate more.



Primary Research: Questionnaire

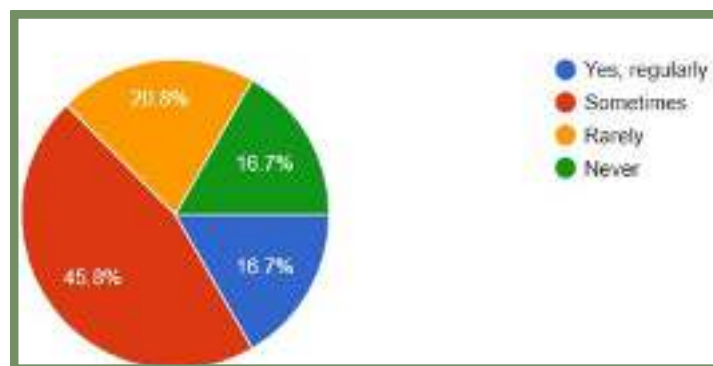
Do you consider yourself superstitious?



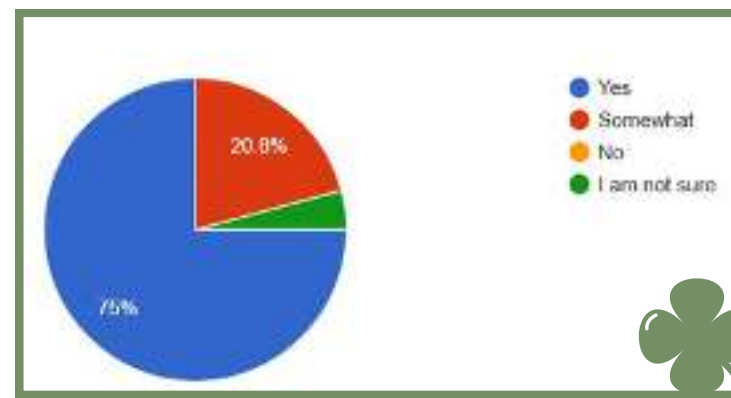
On a scale of 1 to 5, how often do you feel anxious in your daily life? [1 = Never, 5 = Very Often]



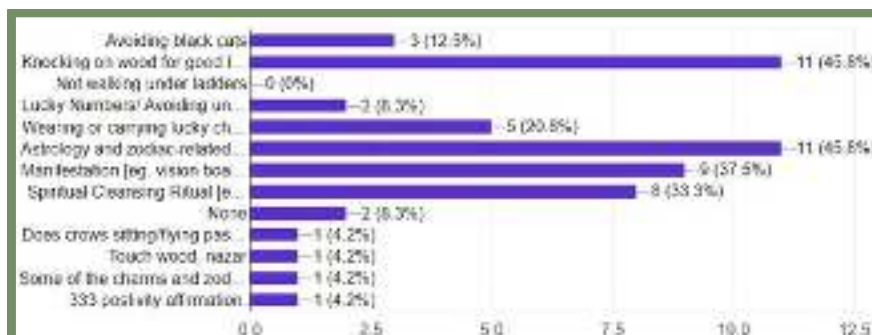
Do you engage in manifestation practices [eg. vision board, affirmation]?



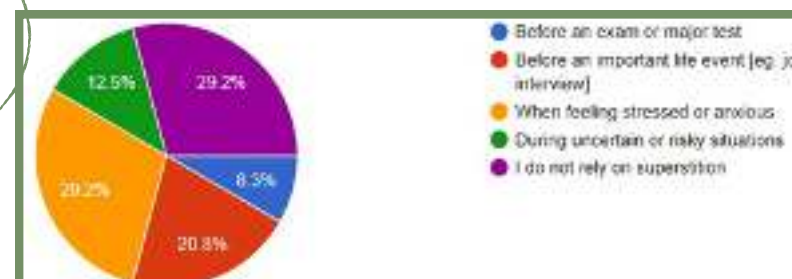
Do you think that there is a difference between superstition and religion?



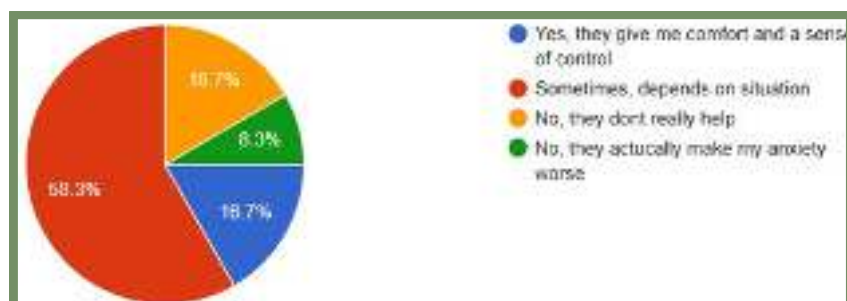
Which of the following superstitions do you believe in or practice?



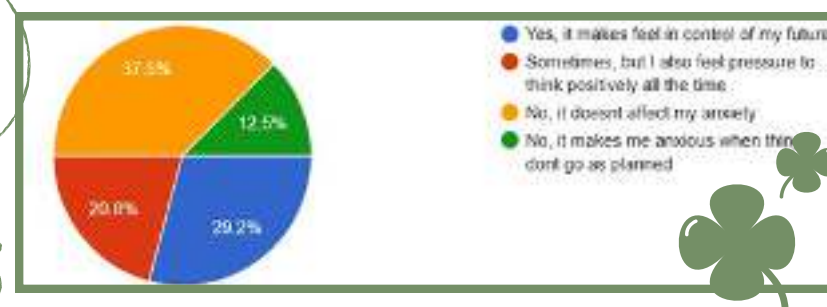
When do you rely on superstition the most?



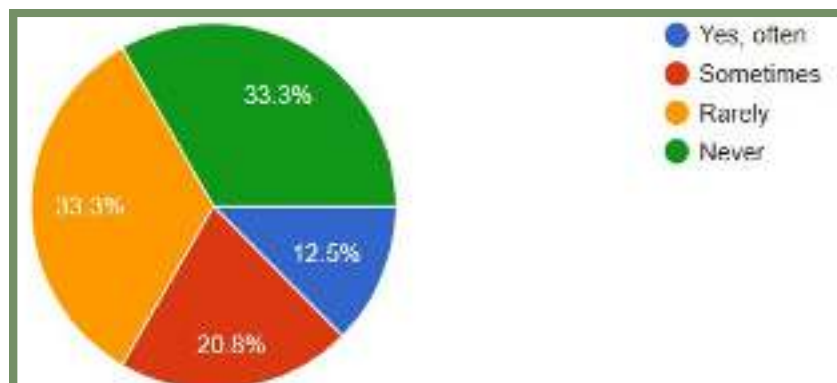
Do you think superstitions help reduce anxiety?



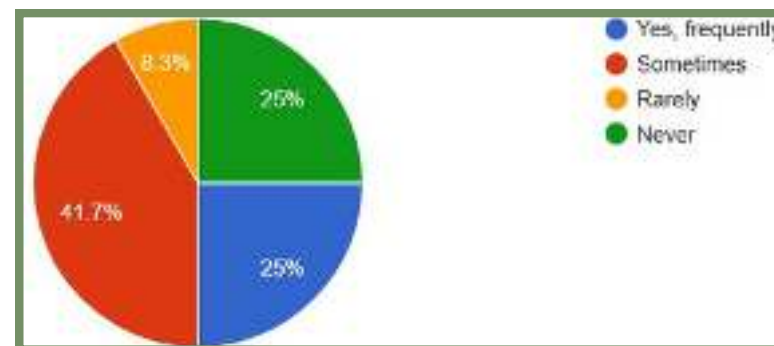
Do you think manifestation helps reduce your anxiety?



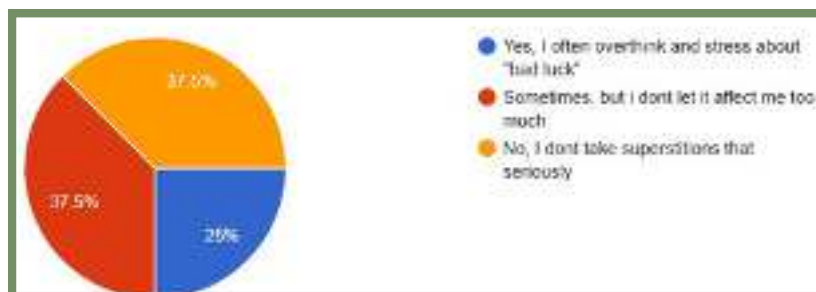
Have you ever felt anxious that you were "manifesting" something negative by thinking bad thoughts?



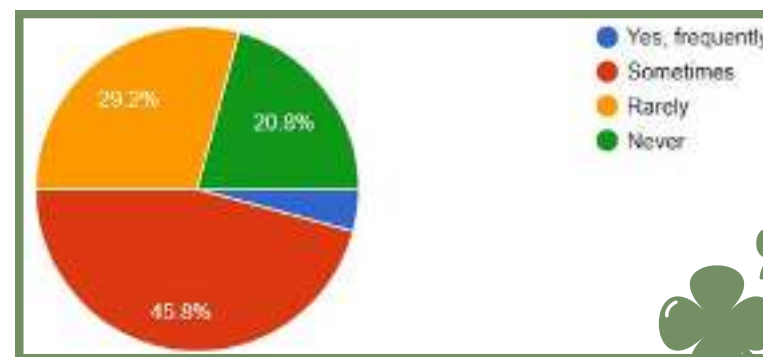
Have you ever felt anxious or uneasy because you were unable to follow a superstition you believe in?



Do superstitions make you more worried about possible outcomes?

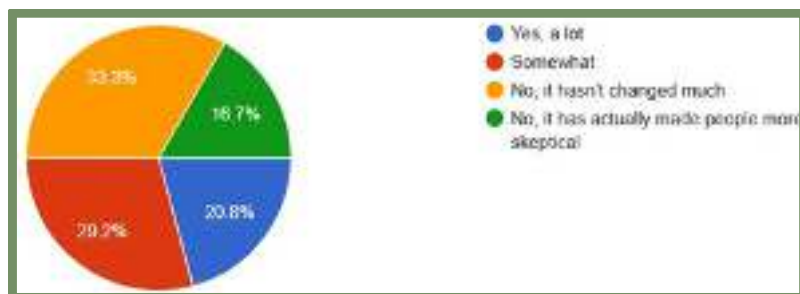


Have you ever changes your behavior or decision-making due to a superstition or manifestation belief?



Primary Research: Insights

Do superstitions make you more worried about possible outcomes?



- Most GenZ believe in manifestation and some in superstition.
- GenZ believes in astrology and zodiac signs also the superstition of knocking on the wood for good.
- They tend to use superstitions when they are stressed or anxious, before important life events, example: job interview etc.
- Superstitions help them to reduce anxiety depending on the situation.
- 30.8% of GenZ feel manifestation helps them feel in control of their future meaning a sense of control on situation.
- 38.5% of GenZ change their behavior or decision making due to a superstitious belief or a manifestation belief.
- 23.1% of GenZ believe that social media has increased the belief in superstition or manifestation.
- One interesting question that I asked was "Do you think that there is a difference between superstition and religion?".



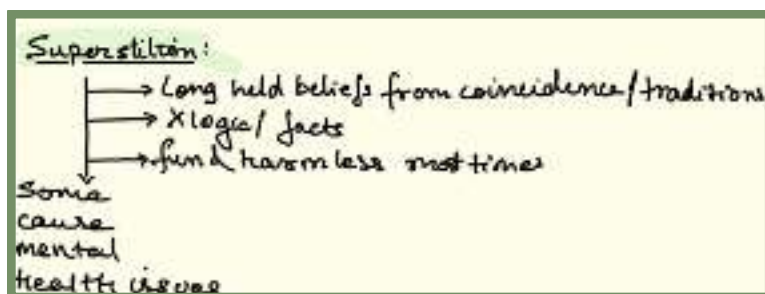
Secondary Research: Research Questions

- What is Superstition?
- What is Manifestation?
- What are common superstition?
- What is the impact of social media on manifestation?
- How has superstition evolved across cultures and what is their role in managing anxiety?
- How does superstition functions as coping mechanisms for anxiety in an uncertain situation?
- Is manifestation bad for mental health?
- Studies done to show effect of superstition on anxiety.
- What superstitions are followed by Gen Z?
- Supersititons and Social Media
- Superstitions GenZ follow



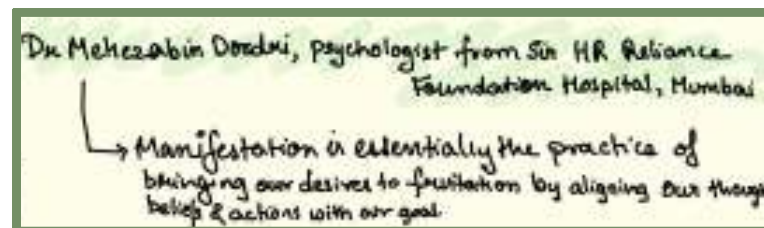
Secondary Research: Research Questions

What is Superstition?:

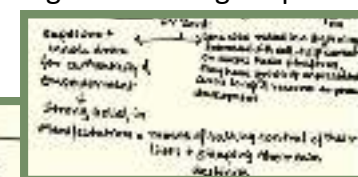
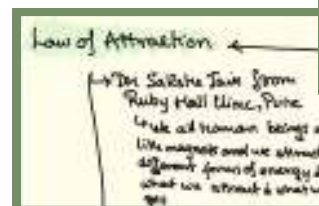


- Deeply rooted beliefs in culture that lack scientific support, influences people's perceive and face situations in everyday life.
- These are rooted on magical thinking and oral thinking throughout history as integral part of culture world.
- It can have a profound effect on risk assessment and avoidance behaviour.
- It affects professional realm.
- It stems from desire to control situation.

What is Manifestation?:

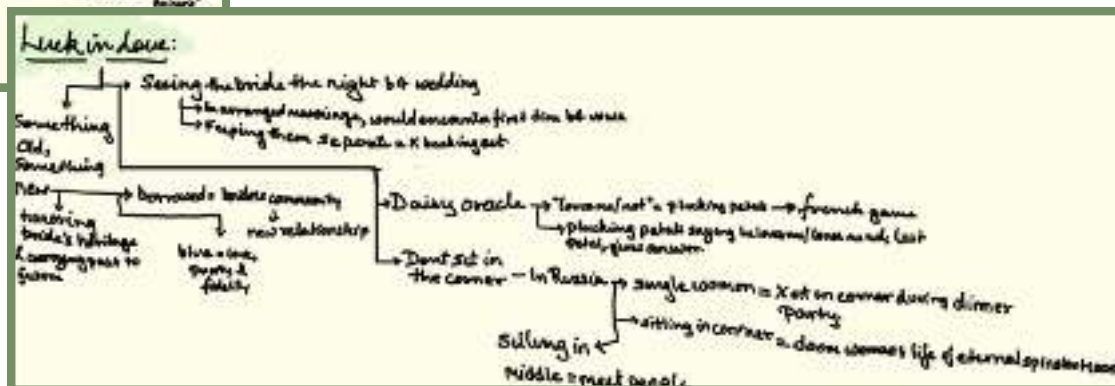
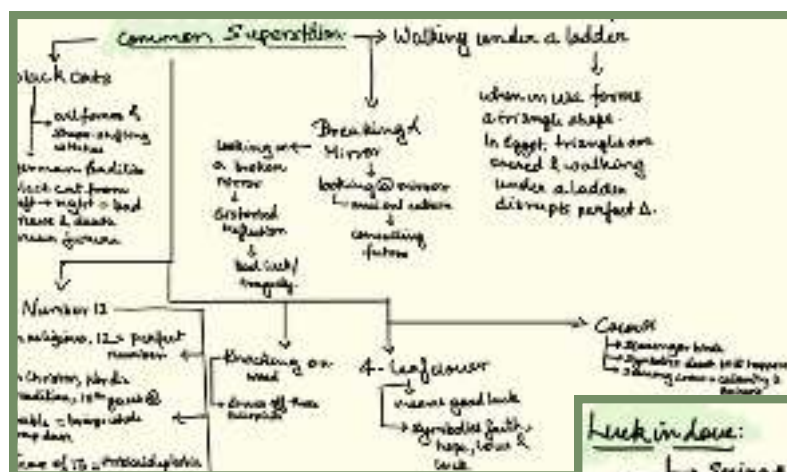


- Law of attraction: Like attract like, if you think well and work towards it, you can achieve that goal with the power of your mind.
- Indian Philosophy: Accha Socho, Accha Hoga
- Most GenZs are atheists, but believe in Universe,
- 2005 study, shows people with positive effect tend to experience higher level of happiness.
- 2018 study, visualizing desires = higher probability of achieving them

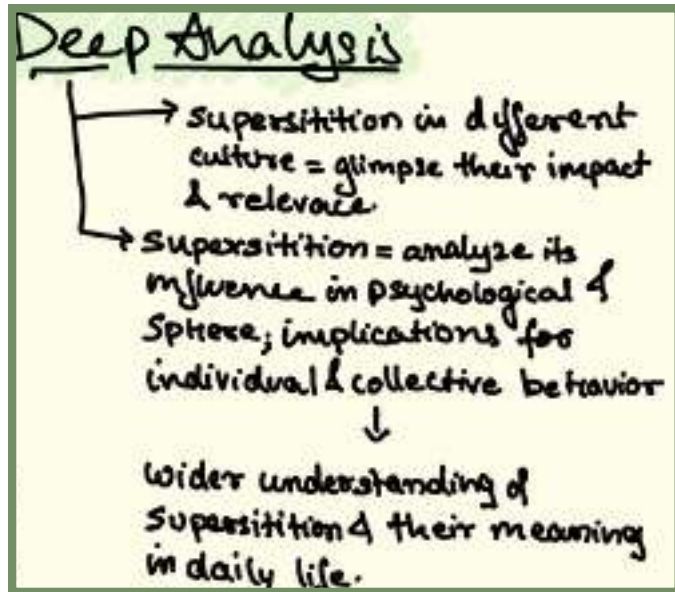


What are common superstitions?:

- Itchy hands are considered to be a sign that wealth is on the way or that the person shall soon hold money.
- Boiling rice or milk at new house symbolizes fullness, prosperity and wealth.
- Saying “God Bless You”, this was started before people understood how disease were transmitted. It is said to be a blessing to ward off evil spirits.
- Evil eye, wearing an evil eye or using the emoji in text keeps people safe from what people call “nazar”.



How has superstition evolved across cultures and what is their role in managing anxiety?:



- Superstitions change over time, influenced by factors like globalization and diffusion of ideas.
- Cultures have gone through complex process of creating transmitting and adaptations.
- It helps give a false sense of control over the situation reducing stress and anxiety.

How does superstition functions as coping mechanisms for anxiety in uncertain situation?:

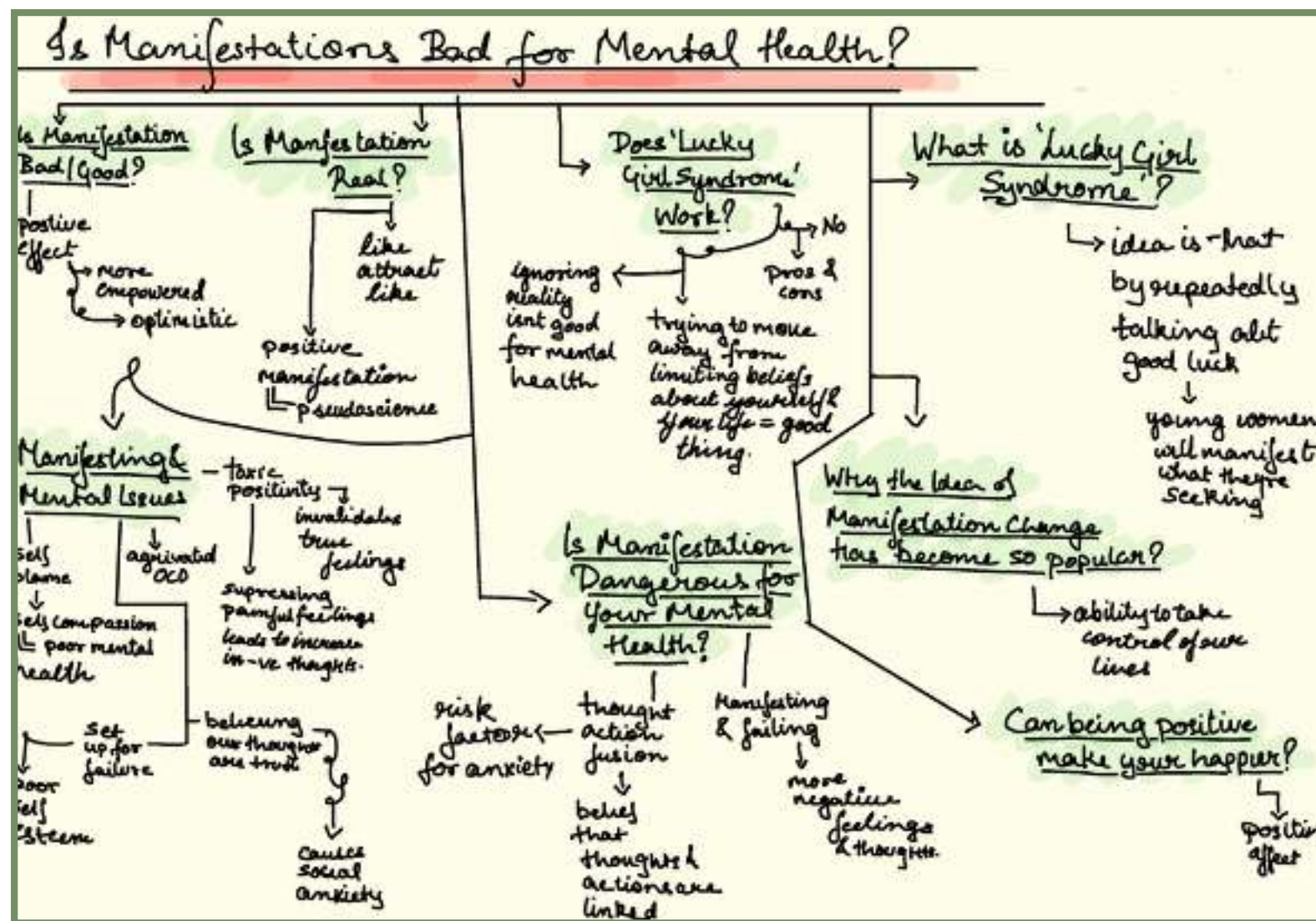
- It helps boost confidence by giving a sense of certainty, sense of control and enhancing self-identification.
- It also reduces anxiety and enhances well beings, increases optimism.
- It helps to promote positive thoughts.
- Uncertainty and Anxiety play a significant role in fueling superstition.
- Superstition gives order and predictability acts as a security blanket.
- But at the same time, it causes irrational thinking and increases anxiety.

What is the impact of social media on manifestation?

- Influencers, content creators share their stories of successful manifestation stories causing people to believe.



Is manifestation bad for mental health?:



What superstitions are followed by Gen Z?:

- Some of the superstitions that Gen Z look at the most are the use of the evil eye, crystals and sages to protect against negative energy.
 - Black cats and palm scratching are also superstitions still helped by Gen Z, who is careful not to invite evil spirits into one's life and home.
 - New Year Rituals like having 12 grapes on the stroke of midnight and making a wish after each grape.
-

Supersititons and Social Media:

- Traditional Superstitions: Cross fingers for good luck before an important meeting or presentation, avoid walking under ladders, throw spilled salt over our shoulder and wishing upon falling star or making a wish while blowing out candles. These help us to seek control in an uncertain world.
- New Superstitions: Digital Lucky Charms by chain mails promising good luck it taps into the desire of controlling ones fate, social media rituals like scrolling through social media before bed to avoid bad dreams or posting specific content to manifest certain desires there may seem harmless but they can become ingrained rituals fueled by anecdotal evidence shared online, tech anxiety and associated superstition like worrying about an evil eye on their social media post or fear of a dropped call during an important conversation, this anxiety leads to avoiding certain apps and numbers in hopes of avoiding bad luck.
- Blurring lines between coincidence and Causation: confirmation bias, meaning social media algorithms tend to show us content that aligns with our existing beliefs. For example, if someone believes 'texting is bad luck' might see stories of others experiencing negative events after texting. This reinforced the superstitions even though there is no causal link. Cherry-picking information, meaning its easy to find some anecdotal stories that support a superstition online, tho these lack proper context and can be misleading.
- Are superstitions harmful in the digital era?: Comfort rituals are harmless superstitions that provide a sense of comfort and control, whereas cultural reminders are traditional superstitions that often hold historical or cultural significance, connecting us to our past and traditions.



Superstitions GenZ follow:

- Knocking on wood: It has a modern spin of knocking on the wood, originally a superstition. Radford said, “Medieval churches would be filled with wood that claimed to be from the cross.” The devout believed that touching the wood would give them a link to the divine and, consequently, good luck.
- Wishing on a star: Once upon a time, pointing to a whole host of things was considered rude. At the same time, twinkling stars were considered to be supernatural beings. “Since it was considered unlucky to point to the star, people would wish on it to petition good luck from it without offending the supernatural being,” Radford says.
- Breaking a mirror: The mirror was once considered to be divine and supernatural, and breaking the image was thought to violate its divinity. As a result, the breaker would receive bad luck.
- Four-leaf clover: Clovers were once believed to keep away witches and were thought to bring good luck. “A four-leaf clover was especially rare and therefore, even more powerful,” Radford explains.
- Bad news comes in threes: three establishes a pattern. Something happening once could be random; twice could just be a chance, but the third time means something, Radford says.
- Don’t open an umbrella inside: Radford says it’s not entirely clear where this came from, but it could be that earlier umbrellas had a tight spring that could catch and injure a finger. If you were going to use one, it best to do so when you actually needed it.
- Beginner’s luck: This could be as simple as a way to encourage people to try something new, Radford says. It also is said that when someone plays well for the first time, it makes them more competitive.
- Saying “bless you” when someone sneezes: It was once believed that evil spirits could enter a person’s body when they sneezed, Radford says. By saying “bless you,” a person bestows blessings on the sneezer that ward off the evil spirits.



Impact of Superstition on Psychology:

- Superstitions' effect on decision-making and behavior: Decision heuristics: frequently turn to mental shortcuts in high-uncertainty circumstances, and superstitions serve as such. It helps to reduce anxiety, particularly in situations that are beyond their control. Even if it's an illusion, avoiding black cats on Friday the 13th may give a false sense of power over the elements. Social Conformity: Adhering to the prevalent superstitions in the neighborhood might help people feel accepted by others and give them a sense of belonging. Connecting with others who hold similar beliefs might be facilitated by donning an amulet that is said to bring good fortune. Belief in Magical Thinking: Some superstitions are based on the notion that doing particular things directly impacts outcomes, which causes people to make biased decisions.
- What Effects Does Superstition Have on Perception and Cognitive Functions?: Confirmation Biases: People tend to recall and understand events, including superstitions, that support their preexisting views. For example, if people follow a ritual and win a game, they will credit the ritual for the victory. Selective Attention: Overlooking contradicting information in favor of situations that seem to validate beliefs. Someone may not think it matters to the previous belief if one avoids stepping beneath a ladder and then trips later. Illusory Control caused by engaging in superstitious practices can give one a false sense of control over chance occurrences, which can breed overconfidence or a misplaced fear of danger. Real-world repercussions might include taking unwarranted chances because one feels "lucky."
- Can Superstition Lead to the Development of Irrational Beliefs?: Leaping to Conclusions makes it possible to create cause and effect links by connecting random occurrences with routines. Even when there is no real link, the belief in a fortunate charm's magical power may be strengthened if it coincides with success. Ignoring Evidence, people may reject or rationalize away evidence that challenges superstitious beliefs. This affects reasonable decision-making and critical thinking. Transmission and Reinforcement superstitions have the power to perpetuate an unfounded belief system that is passed down through generations and reinforced in local communities. Certain superstitions may get internalized by children without them ever challenging their integrity.



Impact of Superstition on Psychology:

- **How Can Confirmation Bias Contribute to the Perpetuation of Superstitious Beliefs?:** Seeking confirming evidence causes people to go out of their way to find events that support their beliefs. If a person thinks that smashing mirrors brings bad luck, they may notice unrelated positive happenings unconsciously after such an incident and ignore unfavorable ones. In interpreting Ambiguity, neutral events can be understood to reinforce preexisting ideas. The superstition may be to blame for a flat tire on a bad day instead of normal wear and tear. Discounting Contradictions research that challenges superstition is frequently minimized or ignored. When a fortunate charm does not work, it is common to attribute its failure to other influences rather than the charm itself.
- **Does Superstition Affect How Stress and Anxiety Are Experienced?:** Feeding fear by explaining unexpected occurrences, especially bad ones, superstitions can increase anxiety. The concern and tension from the idea that certain activities may bring “bad luck” can be averted. Rumination and Obsession: Adopting superstitious practices or avoiding unfortunate circumstances can cause negative rumination and obsessive thinking, which can exacerbate long-term stress and anxiety. Breaking the cycle: Although superstition rituals are useless over the long term, they can give some people a fleeting sensation of control and anxiety alleviation.
- **Does Superstition Have Positive Psychological Effects in Specific Situations?:** Hope and Optimism, positive affirmation, or lucky charms may increase self-assurance and motivation, improving performance in specific circumstances. Cultural Connection, social ties and a sense of belonging can be strengthened by superstitions, which are an important component of cultural identity and traditions. Shared rituals and beliefs may foster community and support, which can benefit mental health. Placebo Effect, favorable expectation and self fulfilling prophecies can result in favorable outcomes when a superstition's effectiveness is believed. This can be helpful in circumstances where mentality and confidence are important factors.
- **What Effects Does Superstition Have on Mental Health and Overall Well-Being?:** Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder (OCD), Impaired Decision-Making, Superstitions can cause prejudice and illogical thinking, affecting decisions about relationships, careers, and physical health. Critical thinking and a solid grasp of cognitive biases are essential to handle these circumstances. Vulnerability to Mental Illness: People who already suffer from mental illnesses may occasionally be more vulnerable to the harmful effects of superstitions, which might exacerbate symptoms such as anxiety and sadness.



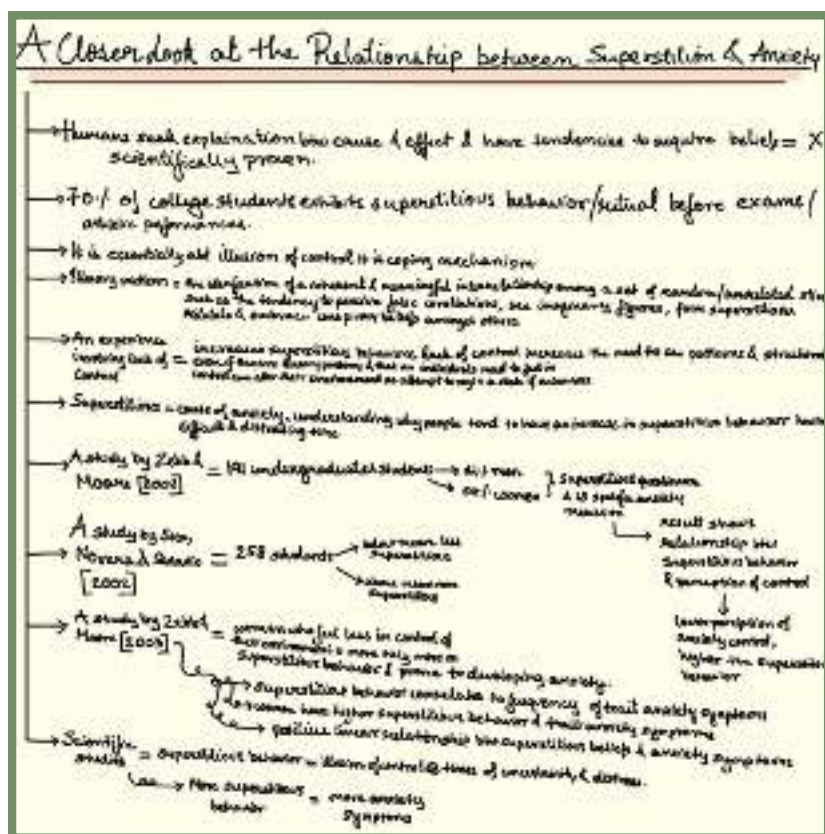
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Secondary Research: Relevant Studies

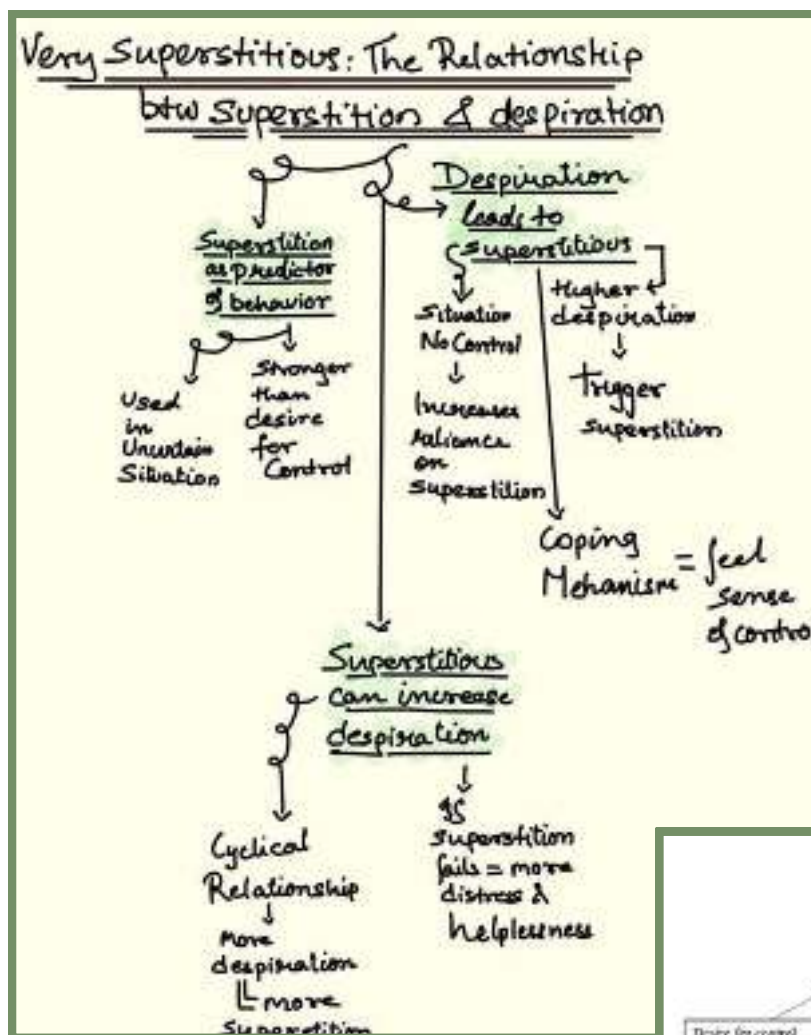
A Closer Look At The Relationship Between Superstition And Anxiety:



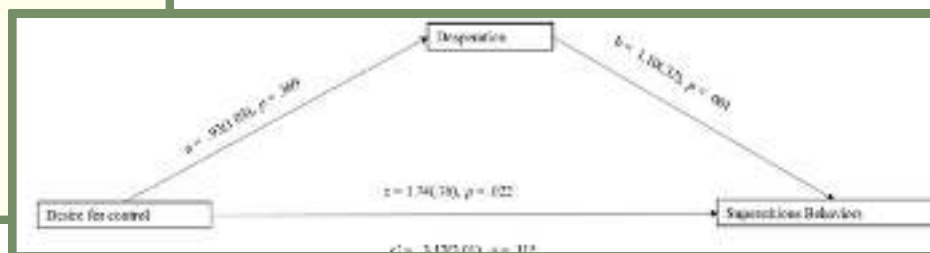
- A study by Zebb and Morre [2002]: 191 undergraduate students were part of the survey, 41% men and 59% women. There was a superstition specific questionnaire and 13 anxiety specific measures. This showed that there was a relationship between superstitious behavior and perception of control meaning; lower the perception of anxiety control, higher the superstitious behavior.
- A study by Sica, Novara & Sanavio [2002]: 258 students were part of the survey. Those who scored below mean = less superstitious and those who scored above mean = more superstitious.
- A study by Zebb and Morre [2003]: This showed that women feel less in control of their environment = more relying on superstitious behavior = prone to anxiety. Superstitious behavior correlates to frequency of trait anxiety symptoms. It shows positive linear between superstition and anxiety symptoms.
- Scientific studies: Superstitious behavior = illusion of control at time of uncertainty and distress, More superstitious = More anxiety.
- Citation: Futrell, Brandy. A Closer Look at the Relationship Between Superstitious Behaviors and Trait Anxiety.
- Link: <https://scholarship.rollins.edu/rurj/vol5/iss2/5>



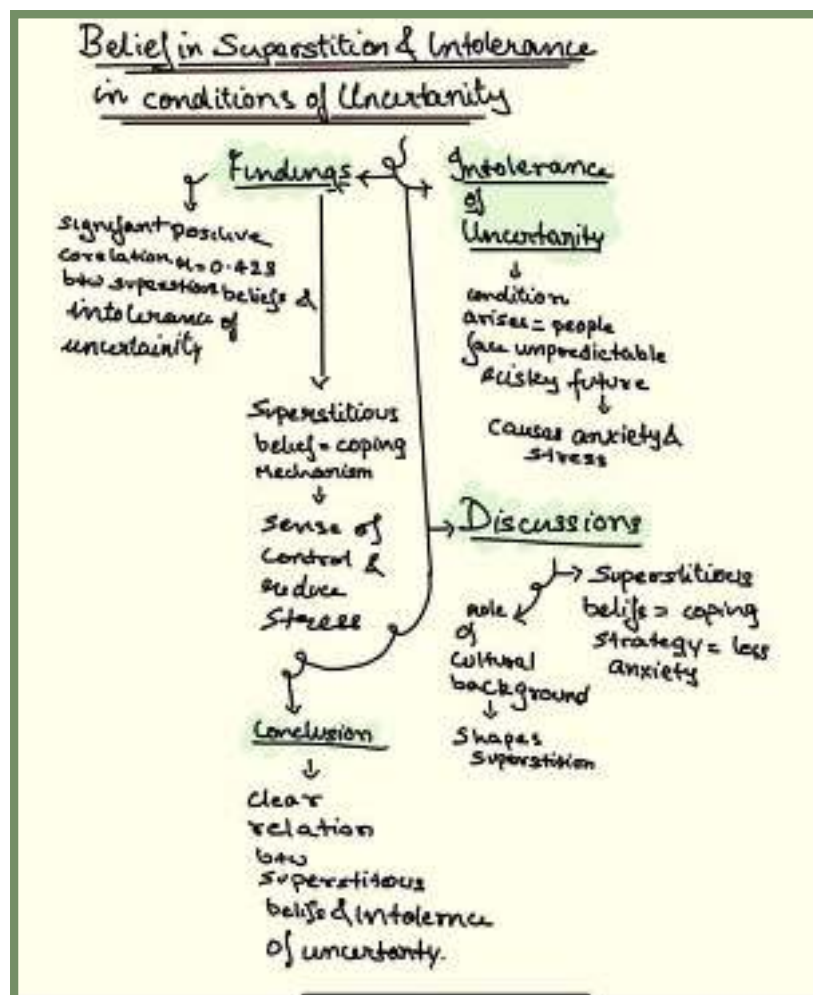
Very Superstitious: The Relationship Between Superstition And Desperation:



- The path from desire for control to desperation ($a = .93$, $p = .369$) is not significant (p -value is greater than .05), meaning wanting control does not strongly lead to desperation.
- The path from desperation to superstitious behaviors ($b = 1.10$, $p < .001$) is strong and significant, meaning the more desperate people feel, the more likely they are to engage in superstitions.
- The direct path from desire for control to superstitious behaviors ($c' = 3.17$, $p = .115$) is not significant, meaning wanting control alone does not make someone more superstitious.
- However, desire for control indirectly influences superstition through desperation ($c = 1.74$, $p = .022$), meaning when people want control but feel desperate, they turn to superstitions.
- **Citation:** Hannan, Christopher Evan. Very Superstitious: The Relationship Between Desperation and Superstitious Behavior. Murray State Theses and Dissertations. Murray State University, 2019.
- **Link:** <https://digitalcommons.murraystate.edu/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=1175&context=etd>.



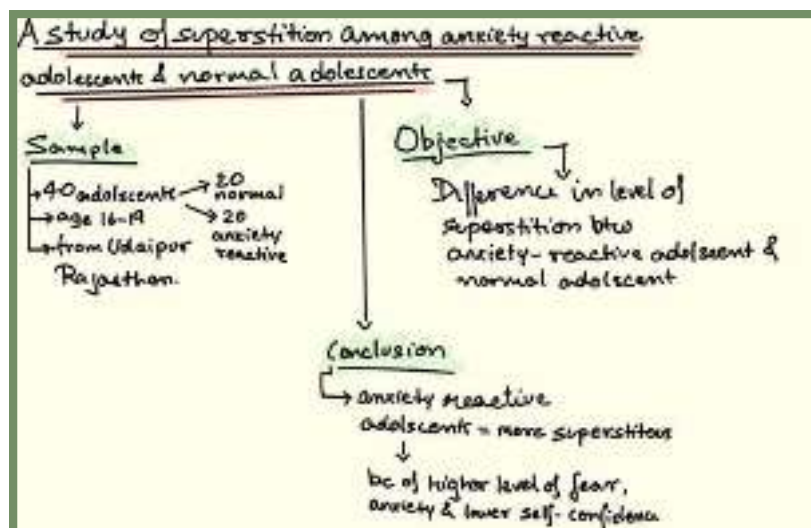
Being Superstitious and Intolerance In Conditions Of Uncertainty:



- The study involved 395 Javanese individuals aged 18-65.
- Intolerance of uncertainty was measured using the IUS-12 scale, while superstitious beliefs were assessed based on belief in events, rituals, and objects.
- IUS-12 scale (Intolerance of Uncertainty Scale-12) is a psychological tool used to measure how much a person struggles with uncertainty.
- Citation: Pamardisiwi, Tiara Awanisa, and Amri Hana Muhammad. "Belief in Superstition and Intolerance in Conditions of Uncertainty." *Journal of Social and Industrial Psychology* 12, no. 2 (2023): 76-81.
- Link: <https://digitalcommons.murraystate.edu/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=1175&context=etd>.



A Study Of Superstition Among Anxiety Reactive Adolescents And Normal Adolescents:



- The mean score on the Superstition Scale for anxiety-reactive adolescents was 37.9, while for normal adolescents, it was 29.3.
- The t-value was 5.65, which was significant at the 0.05 level.
- This indicates that anxiety-reactive adolescents have significantly higher levels of superstition compared to normal adolescents.
- **Citation:** R Paliwal & A Joshi (2019). A study of superstition among anxiety reactive adolescents and normal adolescents. International Journal of Indian Psychology, 7(4), 1021-1024.
DIP:18.01.120/20190704, DOI:10.25215/0704.120
- **Link:** <https://ijip.in/wp-content/uploads/2020/01/18.01.120.20190704.pdf>

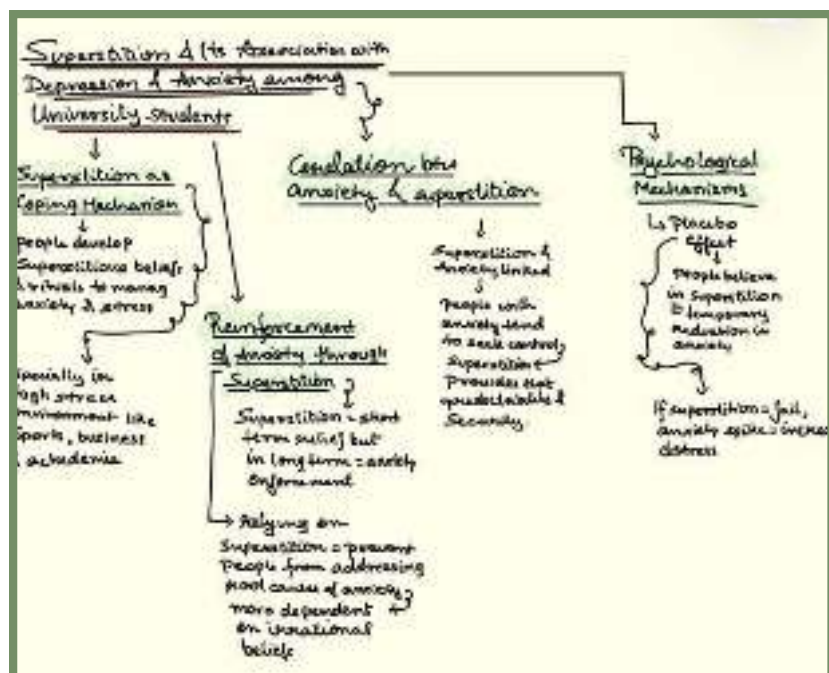
Table 1 showing Means, Standard Deviations and t- value of scores of anxiety reactive adolescent and normal behaviour adolescent on Superstition Scale (SS).

Group	Mean	S.D.	t- Value
Anxiety reactive adolescent	37.9	3.75	5.65*
Normal adolescent	29.3	2.57	

*Significant at .05 level



Superstition & Its Association with Depression & Anxiety among University Students:



- **Cultural and Individual Differences:** Some cultures encourage superstitions as a normal response to uncertainty, while others may view them as irrational. Individuals with higher levels of neuroticism or obsessive tendencies are more prone to superstitious thinking as a way to cope with anxiety.
- **Citation:** Pournesaei, G. (2023). Superstition and Its Association with Depression and Anxiety among University Students. *Journal of Modern Psychology*, 3(2), 41-48.
- **Link:** <https://ijip.in/wp-content/uploads/2020/01/18.01.120.20190704.pdf>



Pondicherry Trip: Insights

Reflective Practice: Drawing objects of state of mind before the trip:



Before the trip, we had our A1 jury, so we were all busy working with the deadlines. Hence, I drew a calendar with 21 in red (which was the date of the A1 deadline), an attendance sheet, a laptop with earphones and my journal with reflections written on it.

Reflective Practice: Drawing objects of state of mind after/on the trip:



On the trip, I felt a bit more calmer, relaxed and less anxious. So I drew my phone with earphones, a keychain, the bus, the crystal ball (from the inner chamber of MM), a bracelet and a star key chain.



Pottery:

I am a person who doesn't like to get their hands dirty, so I was very skeptical about this. But after having a go at the wheel I found it relaxed me, helped clear my mind and it gave my mind something to focus on instead of think and over thinking.

Mathiamandhir Trip:

The place was surrounded by nature, which was something I loved about it. Also, the silence really helped me calm down and think through how I did my A1, how to go about further and etc.



Insights:

- I feel the trip helped me relax and calm my mind. It gave me a fresh perspective.
- During the trip, I noticed that when we heard anything good said, we touched wood. I saw many superstitions played out like 11:11.
- It gave me a chance to learn about others' projects.
- I learnt a new superstition that people feel walking on cow dung gives good luck.
- It helped me realise how yoga, music and even nature photography helped me calm down my anxiety.



Sketches

Meme 1:



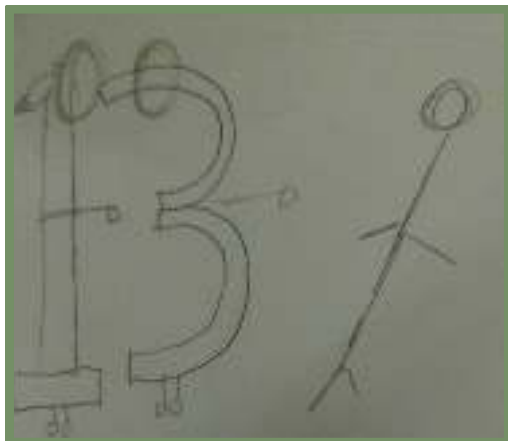
A college scene where 5 mins before an examination, a student is looking for “four-leafed clover” as it represents good luck and she desperately in need of it before her examination.

Meme 2:



A room scene where the college student is sitting with his phone open to the page “List of 11:11 wishes” because 11:11 is considered an angel number, meaning that a time when one wishes on this time helps the wishes come true.
Caption: When the clock gives 60 seconds of hope.



Meme 3:

In a college scene, the guy is being chased by the number 13! He yells, “NOOO!!!!!! I don't want bad luck!! Not 13!!” only to get a reply from the number 13 saying, “Where are you going? I am coming, your bad luck starts now!!!”

Meme 4:

A living room scene where the character from Inside Out 2 “Anxiety” is wrapped in a blanket and surrounded by a “four-leafed clover” and an “evil eye”, and it says “Control Anxiety Control!”

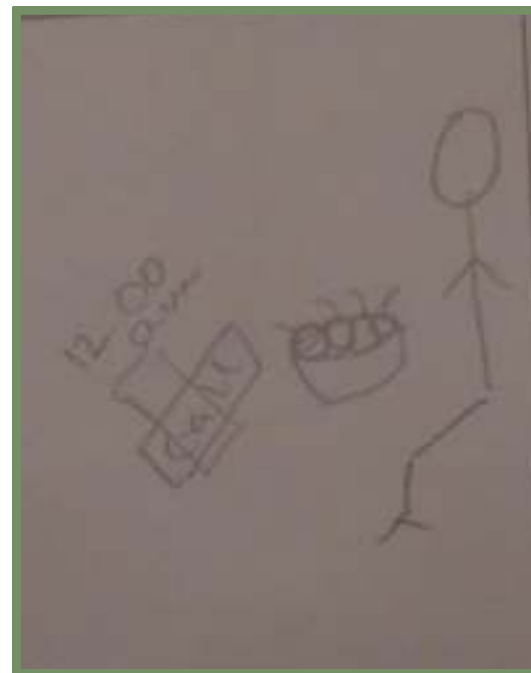
Caption: When superstitions give a false sense of control.



Meme 5:

A college scene where the student is going to class but sees a black cat is in front of him! Scared because black cat represents “bad luck”, little did he know the cat was just as scared of him as he was of it!!

Caption: We are scared of black cats, but have you ever thought about them!?

Meme 6:

A living room scene where the guy is sitting with a bowl of grapes. Each grape is equal to a wish per month for the new year! It has struck midnight, meaning “New Year.” He eats one grape after another, making a wish on how each month of the new year should go! He is thinking, “A grape is equal to a wish for a single month! Hope this works!!”

Caption: When the clock gives 60 seconds of hope to wish for the whole new year



Meme 7:

An auto scene where the auto driver is driving very fast. In the back seat, a college student is sitting and she is freak out because of how fast he is driving. There is a nimbu mirchi hanging in the front near the driver. She sees it and she asks him to drive slower, but all she gets in reply is that he has been driving for years and nothing will happen! She puts her faith in the nimhu mirchi to save her now!

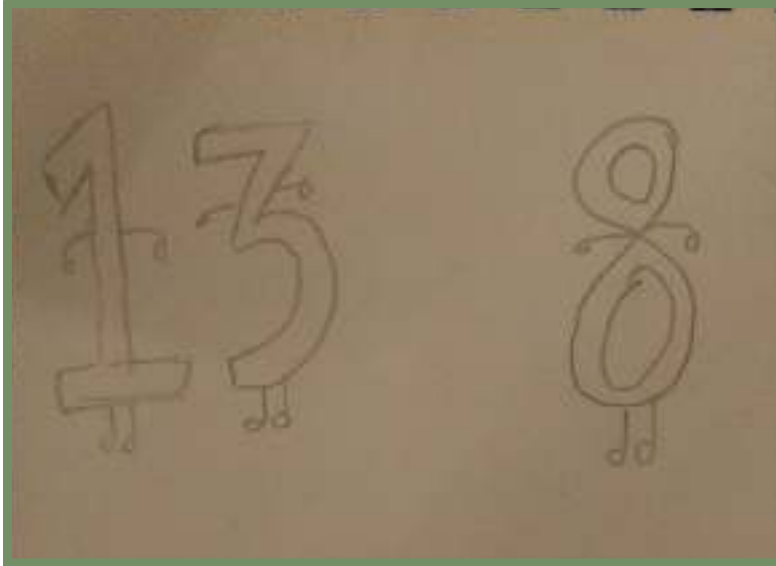
Caption: When the auto driver is going too fast, but you have faith in limbo mirchi!

Meme 8:

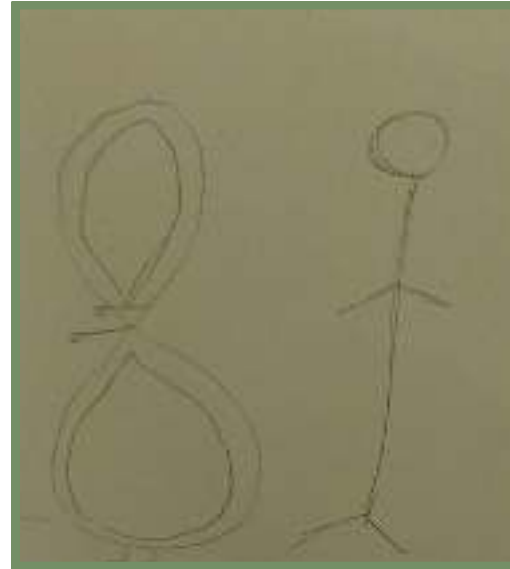
A living room scene where a college student is fast asleep, having a nightmare that is fading because they have a dreamcatcher that is reducing their bad dreams. Where on the couch, there the character from Inside Out 2 "Anxiety," is sitting and watching, feeling sad about the nightmare that it created, but it is reduced due to the dream catcher.

Caption: When u trust the dreamcatcher to give you good dreams.



Meme 9:

A college scene, it is a boxing ring with a fight between the number 13 and the number 8. Where number 13 represents “bad luck”, and number 8 represents “good luck”, respectively.
Caption: When superstitions lead to a war between numbers, and its down to: 8 V/S 13.

Meme 10:

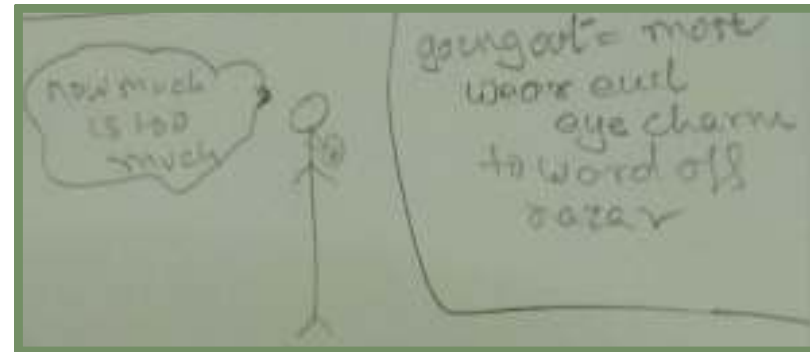
A college scene, it is 5 minutes before an examination, a college student is running after the number 8, which represents good luck. The number 8 says that “Oh so now you remember me.”
The guy says “NOOO!!!!!! WWait, I need your good luck!”
Caption: 5 mins before an examination...



Meme 11:

A living room scene where a college student is thinking that “Today was a great day!” and then thinks “Yikes!! I better knock on wood!”. Where on the couch, there is the character from Inside Out 2, “Anxiety” says, “Did you knock on wood!?”

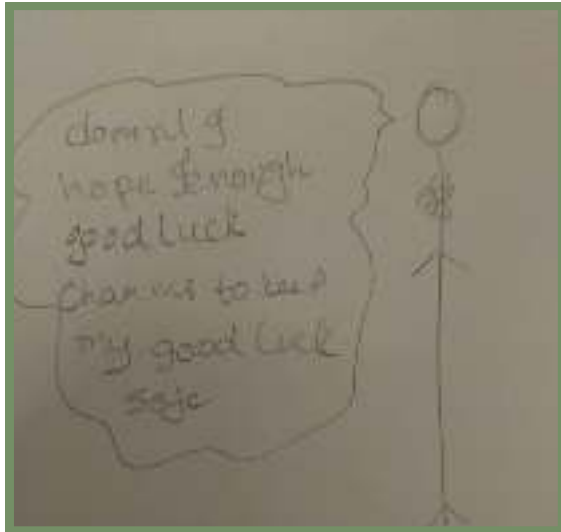
Caption: When you think that you had a good day! But you don’t want to jinx it so you knock on wood!

Meme 12:

A living room scene where the girl is ready to go, dressed up, but makes sure to have two “evil eye” charms on her to make sure “nazar na lage.” Behind her, sitting on the table, is the Inside Out 2 character “Anxiety”, who says “Nazar lag gaya toh!?” and “Wear an evil eye charm!”

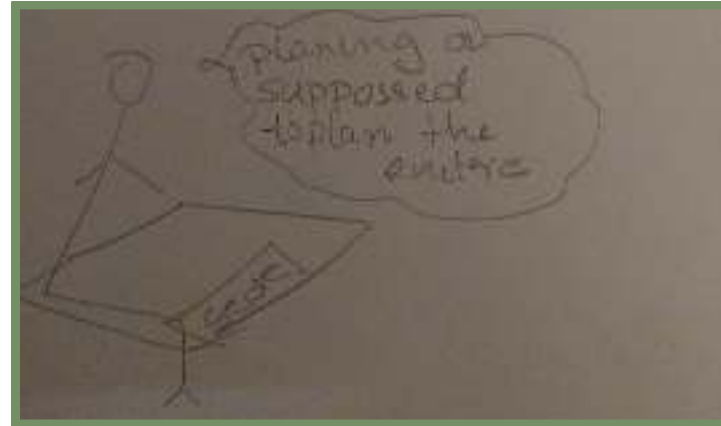
Caption: Whenever you are ready to go outside, an evil eye charm is mandatory!



Meme 13:

A living room scene where the girl is ready to go, dressed up, but makes sure to wear a lot of “four-leafed clover” jewellery to have good luck and says “Damn! I hope I have enough good luck charms to keep my good luck safe”

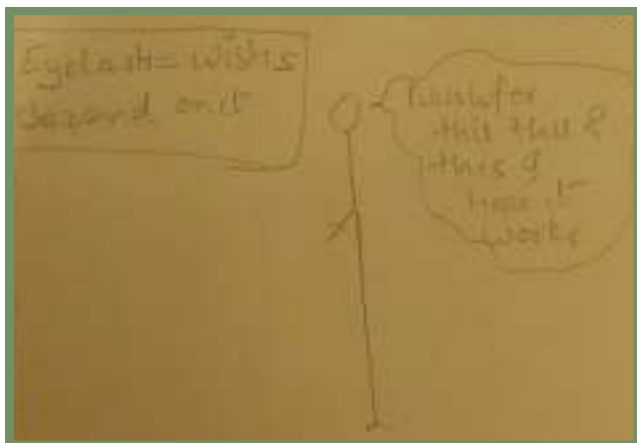
Caption: How many good luck charms are too much!? When your anxiety causes you to carry too many good luck charms!

Meme 14:

A living room scene where the girl is sitting on the floor working on her “vision board” for the next year. She finds it difficult to plan for a whole year in just a month and thinks, “How am I supposed to plan the entire year in a few days!?” and that “it's too hard!”

Caption: When manifesting the year ahead, it sounds easy, but it's very difficult when you have a few days to plan a year!?



Meme 15:

A living room scene where the girl is standing, she notices that her eyelash has fallen. She decides to use this to wish for something, keeping the eyelash on top of her closed fist! She wishes for "I wish for this, this and this.. I hope this works!"

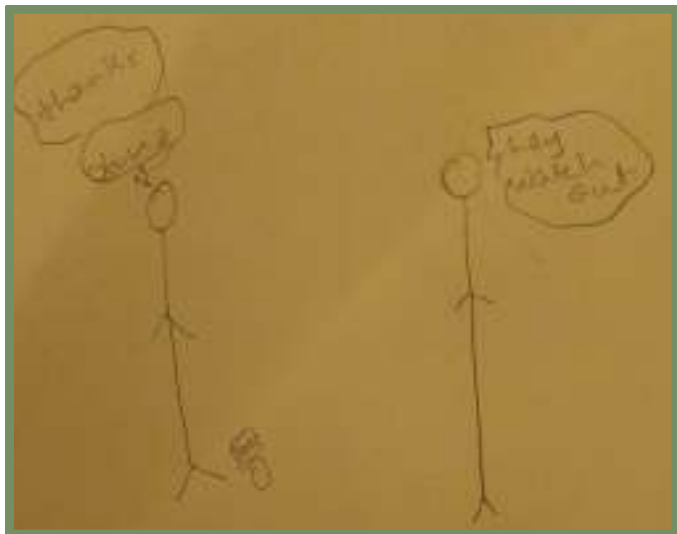
Caption: When your eyelash falls and your wishes depend on it!

Meme 16:

A living room scene where the girl brings a cake to the guy for his birthday and wishes him, asking him to blow the candle and make a wish! The guy blows the candle, makes a wish, and thanks her.

Caption: It's your birthday, and it's time for you to make a wish!



Meme 17:

In a college scene, the guy is running towards the college building to reach his class. He is thinking “NOOO!!!!!! I can't be late for class!!” The girl sees that he is about to step on a nimbu mirchi that has fallen on the ground, she alerts him, saying, “Watch Out! Don't step on that, it's bad luck!” because a fallen nimbu mirchi is considered to be “bad luck”, meaning if anyone steps on it they are inviting “bad luck.”

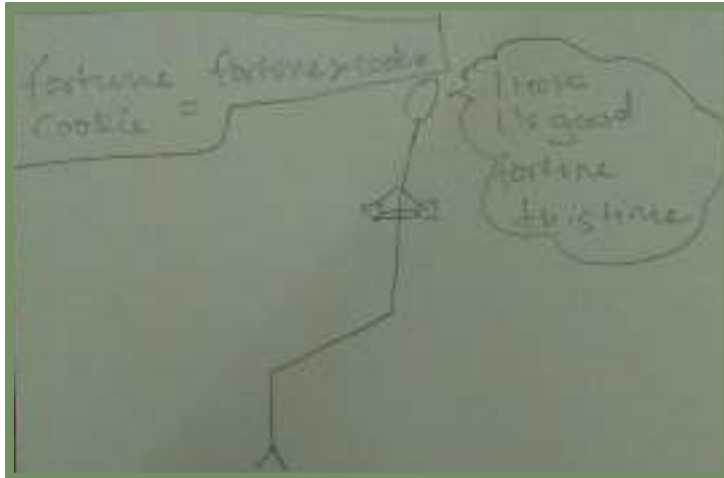
Caption: When being late to class is not as important as not stamping over limbo mirchi!

Meme 18:

In a college scene, the guy is sitting getting a tarot card reading. When the girl reading the card says, “Oh, h OK! WHEEL OF FORTUNE REVERSED” meaning he would get bad luck, he freaks out yelling “WHY ME!?”

Caption: Who said Tarot Card readings are for fun!? Its nerve wracking!!!



Meme 19:

A living room scene where the guy is sitting with a fortune cookie! He is opening his cookie's fortune thinking, "Damn!? I hope it's good fortune this time!!"

Caption: When eating a fortune cookie is more about the fortune than the cookie itself!

Meme 20:

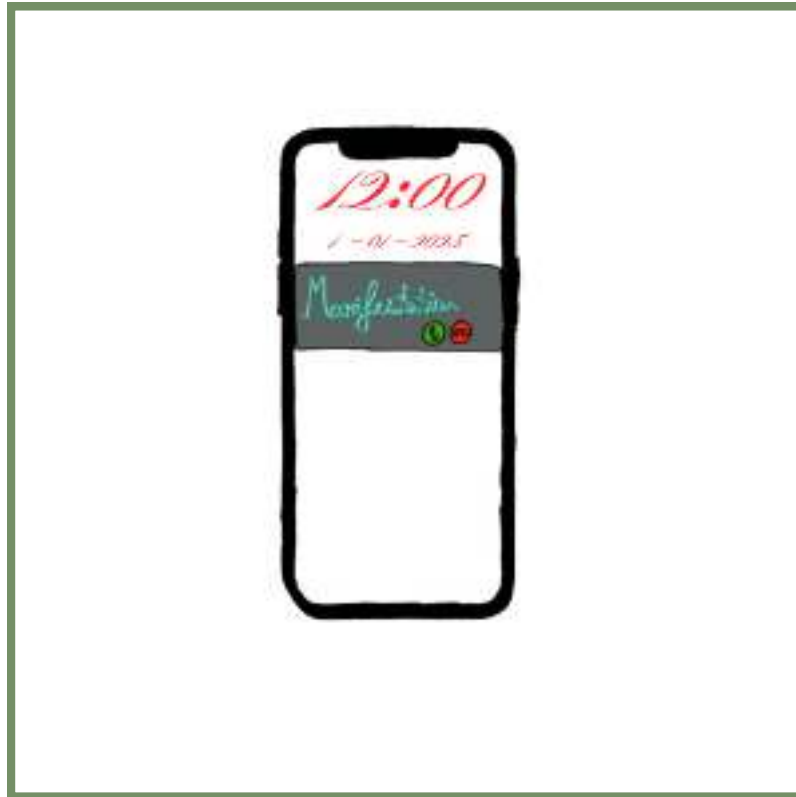
A living room scene where the girl is standing with her best friend. She notices that he looks handsome and says, "Hey! You look handsome today! Nazar Na Lage!!!!" After saying this, she applies her kajal to his face. He replies, "Thank you!"

Caption: When your friend looks handsome and you have to do the "Nazar Na Lage" action!



Elements Of Memes: Iteration 1











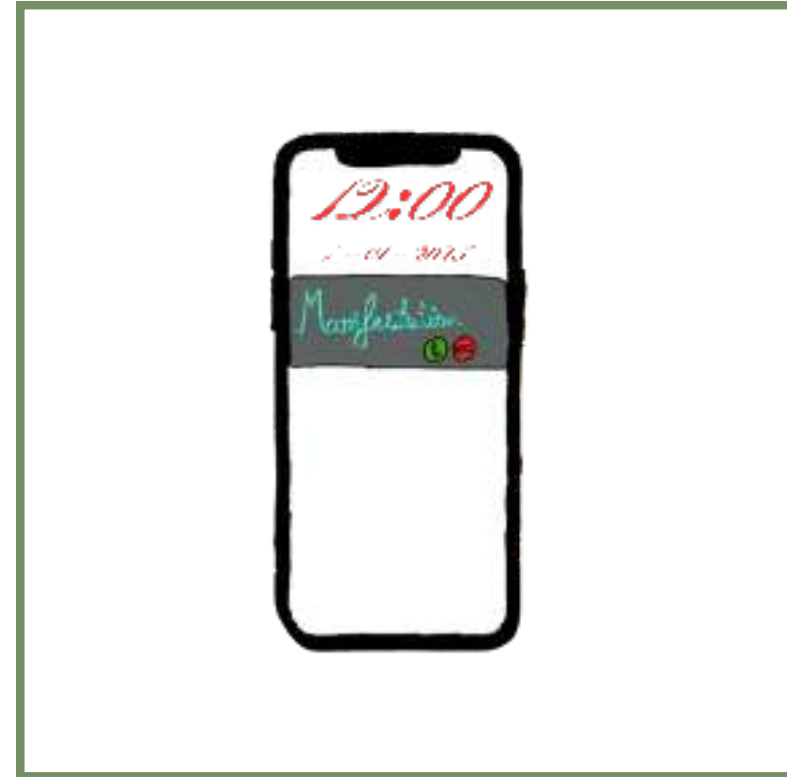
Elements Of Memes: Final Iteration



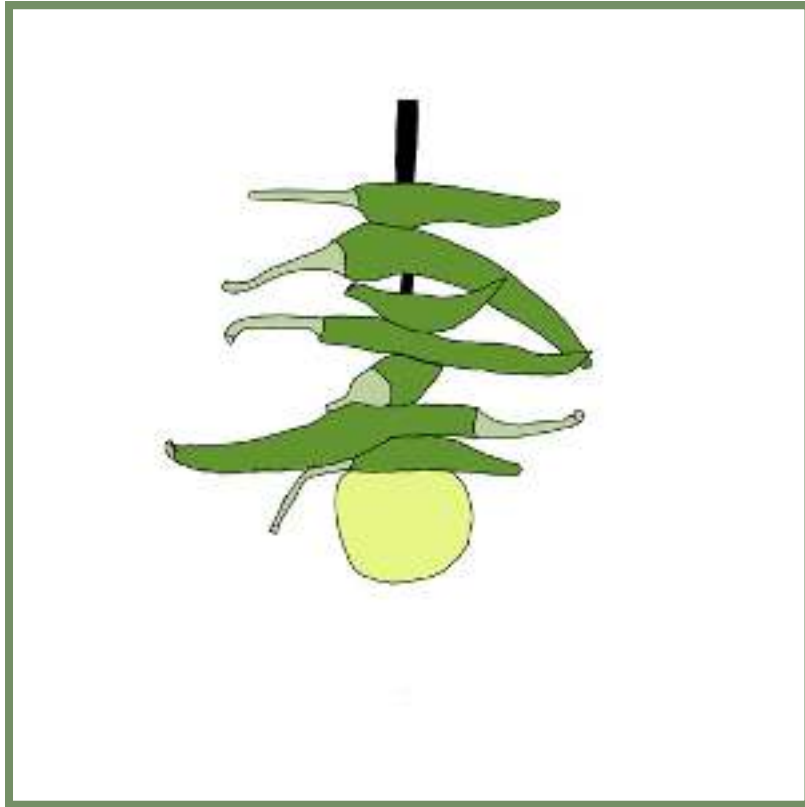






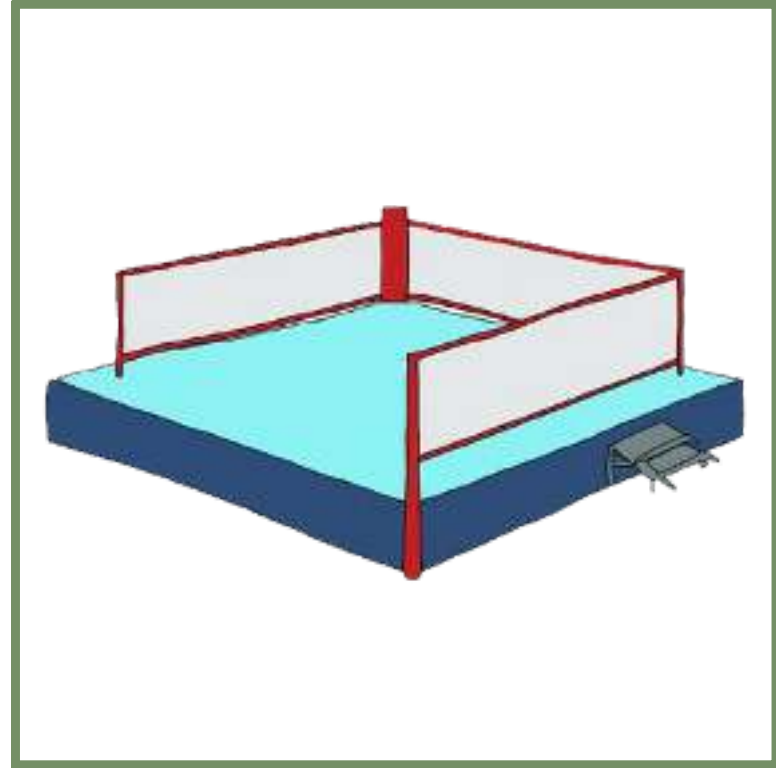








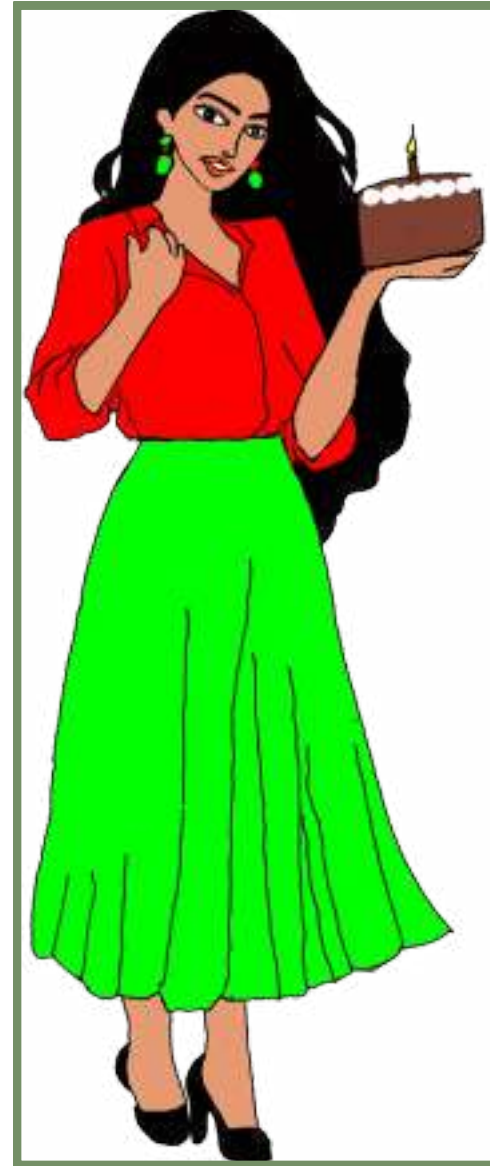






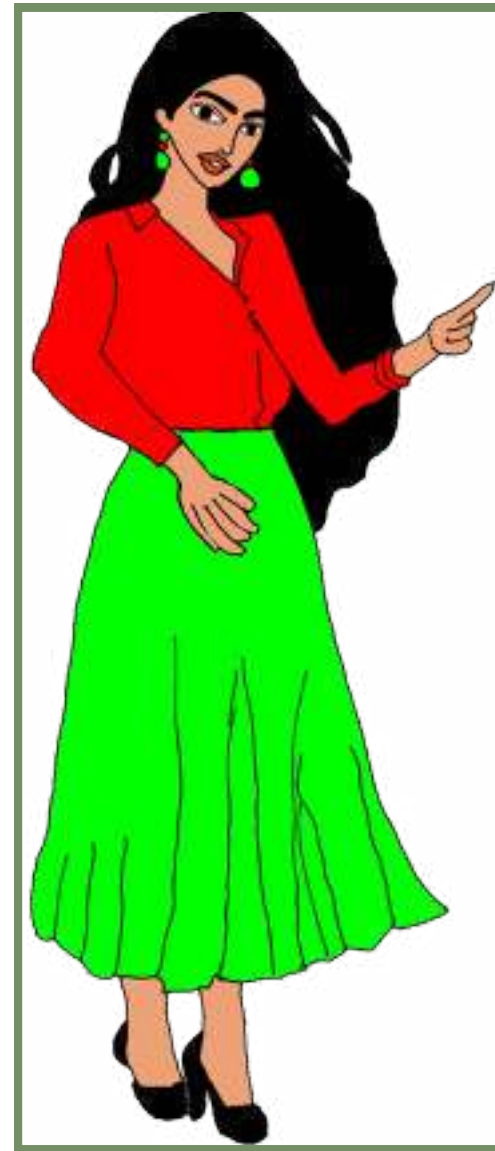






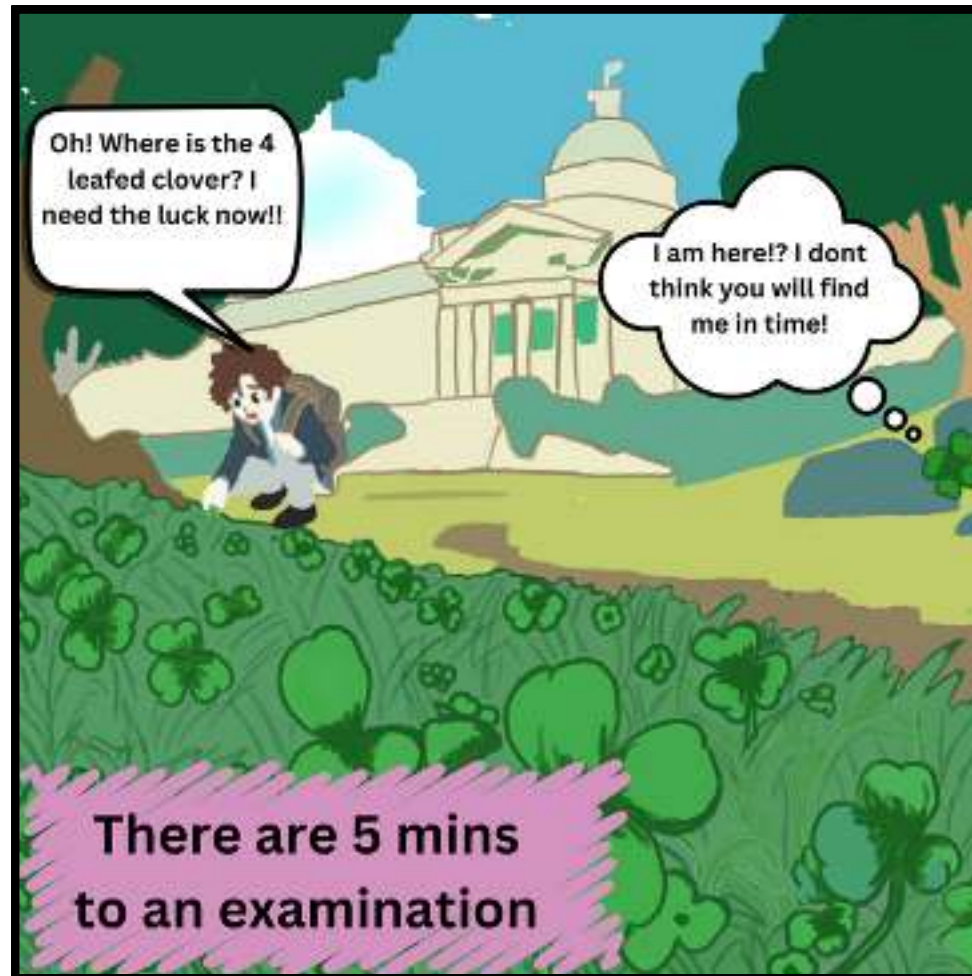






Memes: Iteration 1

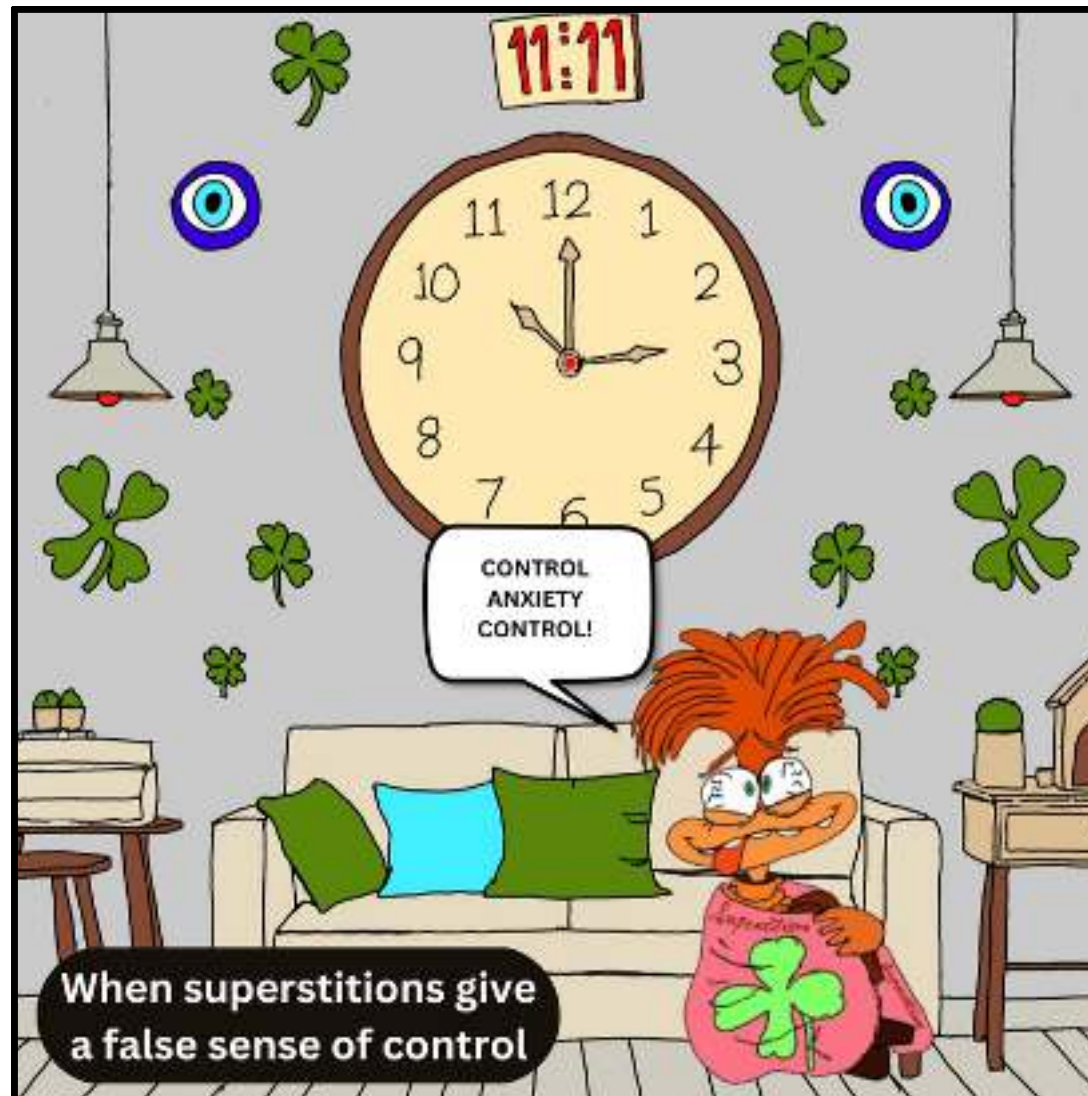
Meme 1:



Meme 2:



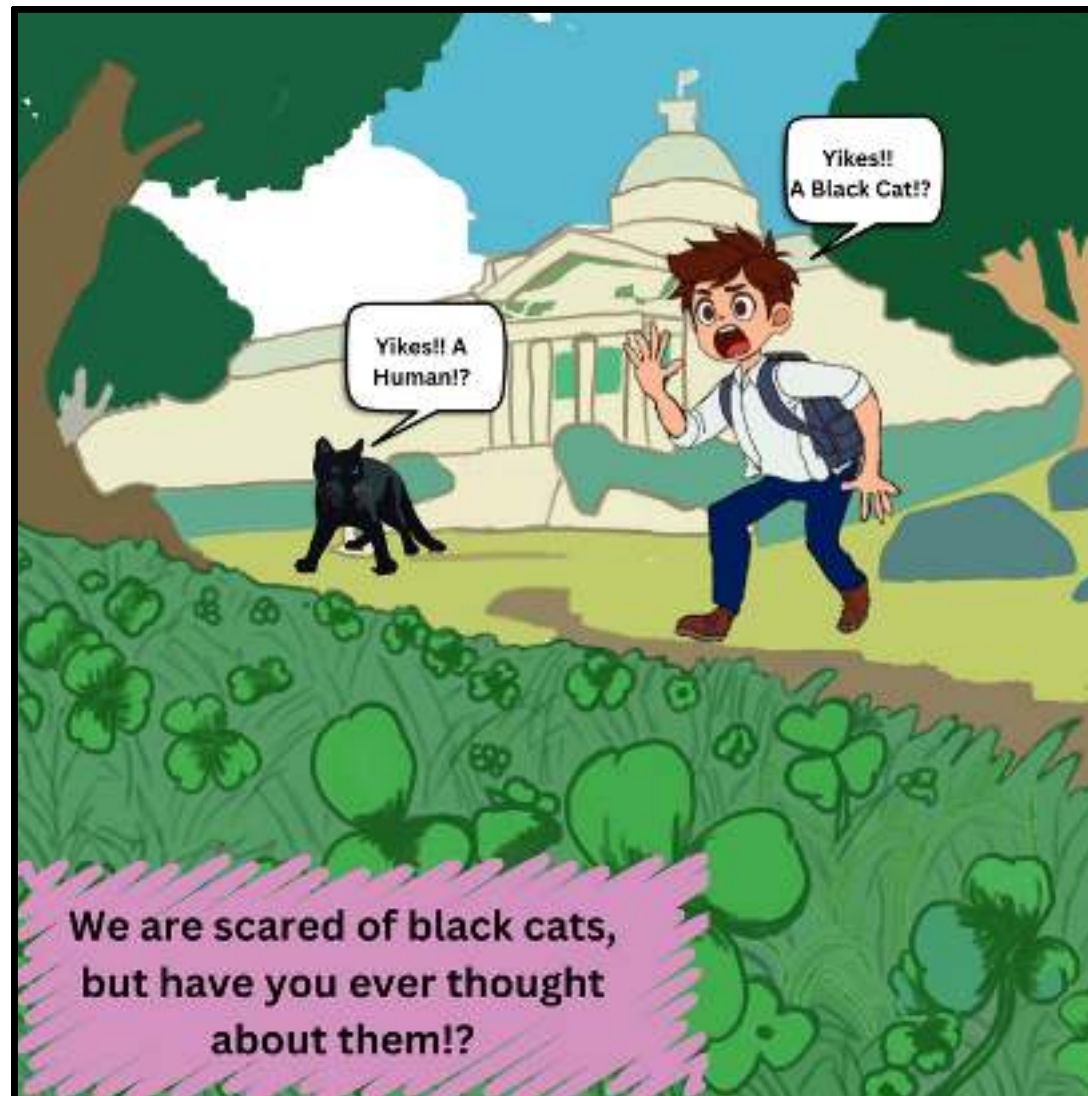
Meme 3:



Meme 4:



Meme 5:



Meme 6:



Memes: Final Iteration

Meme 1:



Meme 2:



Meme 3:



Meme 4:



Meme 5:



Meme 6:



Meme 7:



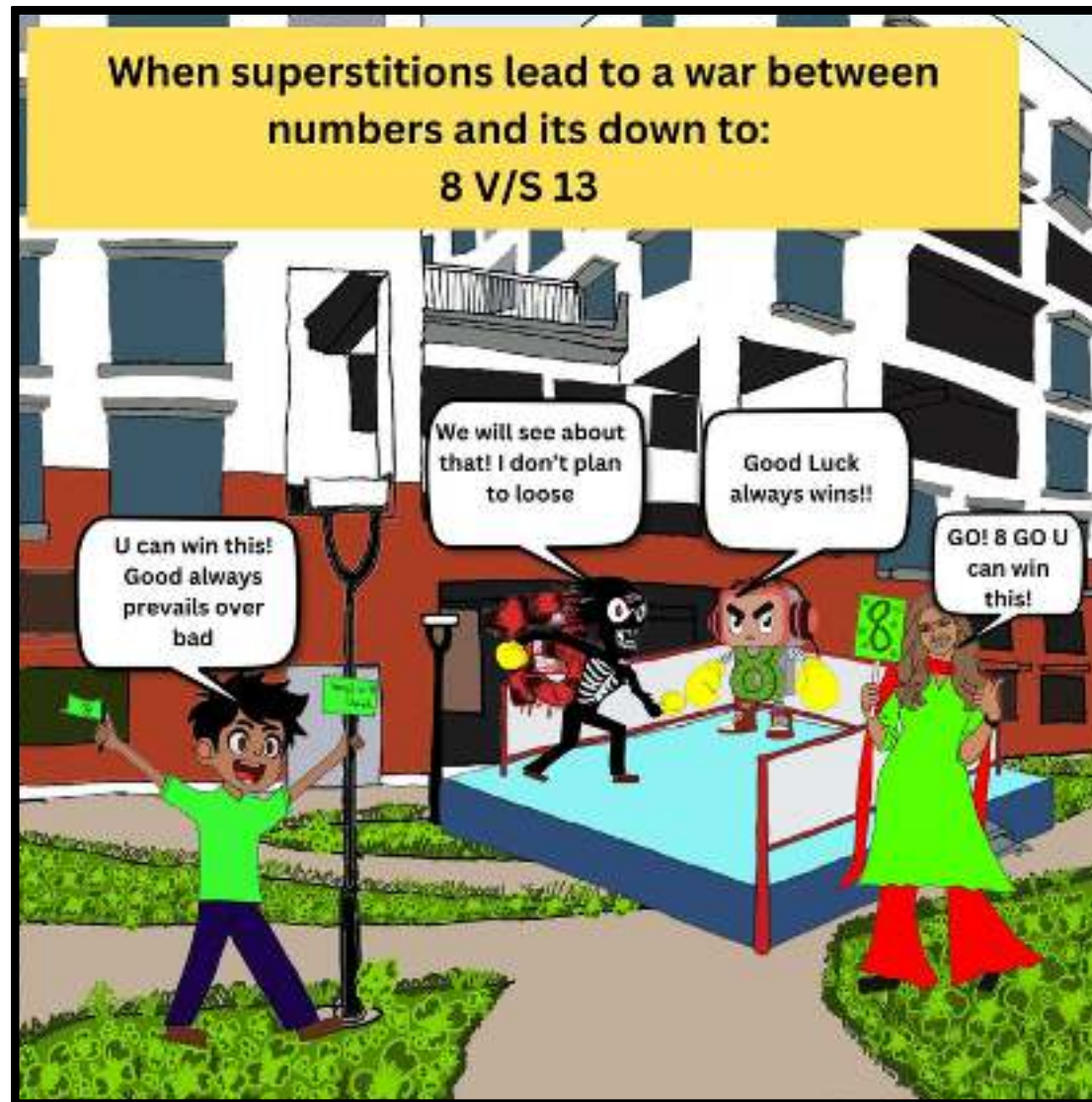
Meme 8:



Meme 9:



Meme 10:



Meme 11:



Meme 12:



Meme 13:



Meme 14:



Meme 15:



Meme 16:



Meme 17:



Meme 18:



Meme 19:



Meme 20:

